PARLESPRINT · TCF CANADA

French A1. From zero.

One book, from your first sound to your first real conversation in Canadian life. Vocabulary, grammar, stories, listening, reading, writing and speaking, in the order you need them.

READ THIS FIRST

How to use this book

This book teaches French from zero to **A1**, the first level of the European scale (CEFR) that TCF Canada uses. It is also the master text of the ParleSprint app: every lesson, story and exercise in the app comes from this book, so you can study on paper or on your phone and nothing changes.

THE ORDER MATTERS

Sounds first (Stage 0), because you must hear French before you read it. Then each unit follows the same path: **words**, then **phrases** (words in blocks), then **one grammar rule** (how the words connect), then a **dialogue**, a **story**, and **listening, reading, writing and speaking** practice. Do not skip ahead. Each unit uses the words of the units before it.

A study session (30 to 45 minutes)

- **Read** one section. Say every French word and sentence out loud, every time.
- **Listen** in the app. The book shows how a word sounds. The app (Marie) says it.
- **Do** the exercise on paper. Then check the answer key at the back.
- **Come back** the next day and say yesterday's words again. Short and regular beats long and rare.

Rule of three. Meet a new word three times in three different days before you decide you know it. The book repeats important words on purpose.

Honest limits. A book cannot play sound. The "Say it" guides use English sounds and are only a rough map. Always check with the app's voice or a French speaker. A fluent speaker should review this book before it is sold.

PRONUNCIATION KEY

The "Say it" guides

Every new word has a guide in blue. French has **no stressed syllable** inside a word: every syllable is nearly the same length. So the guide uses **capital letters only for the last syllable**, which gets a small lift. This is how French rhythm really works.

GUIDE	SOUNDS LIKE	EXAMPLE
ah	a in *father*, short	la → lah
uh	a in *about*. Lips slightly rounded	le → luh
eh	e in *bed*	mère → mehr
ay	ay in *day*, but flat (no glide)	été → ay-TAY
ee	ee in *see*	ici → ee-SEE
oh	o in *go*, short and pure	mot → moh
oo	oo in *food*	vous → voo
ü	say *ee* with your lips rounded as for *oo*	tu → tü
uh / er	the vowel in *her* with rounded lips (eu)	peur → puhr
(n)	nasal vowel. Air goes through the nose. **Do not say the n.**	bon → boh(n)
zh	s in *measure*	je → zhuh
ny	ni in *onion*	montagne → moh(n)-TAHNY
R	the French r, made in the throat (Stage 0)	rue → Rü
wah	oi in French	moi → mwah

In Canada Québec French has its own accent: vowels can be longer or more relaxed, and t and d before i and u sound like ts and dz (*tu* becomes close to "tsü"). The guides in this book give the standard pronunciation you need to be clearly understood and to score well. You will hear Québec French in the app so your ear learns both.

THE EXAM

What TCF Canada tests and where A1 fits

TCF Canada is a French test run by France Éducation international. Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) accepts it for some immigration programs. It has four tests:

TEST	FORMAT	TIME
Listening	39 multiple-choice questions, each recording played **once**	35 min
Reading	39 multiple-choice questions	60 min
Writing	3 tasks: about 60 to 120, 120 to 150 and 120 to 180 words	60 min
Speaking	3 tasks, face to face with an examiner	12 min

Listening and reading questions go from easiest to hardest, and each has four options with one correct answer. A wrong answer and a blank answer both score zero, so **never leave a question empty**. The first questions are A1: a station announcement, a short shop dialogue, a voicemail, a street conversation. This book trains exactly those.

Be honest with yourself. A1 is the first step, not the goal. Most Canadian immigration programs need about **NCLC 7**, which is roughly B2. Check the current score tables on the IRCC website. This book gets you to a solid A1 and builds the habits (listen once, answer every question, write clearly) that the later levels need. A2, B1 and B2 follow in the next books.

THE MAP

Your A1 road map

Stage 0 plus 14 units. At 4 to 5 sessions a week of 30 to 45 minutes, expect about **14 to 18 weeks**. Take longer if you need. Finishing matters, speed does not.

Stage 0: Before you start

- Stage 0: Sounds and spelling

A1: Units 1 to 14

- Unit 1: Introduce yourself
- Unit 2: Greet, be polite, spell your name
- Unit 3: Forms and papers
- Unit 4: Family and people
- Unit 5: Numbers, money and prices

STAGE 0

0

Sounds and spelling

AFTER THIS UNIT YOU CAN

Read French aloud correctly, spell your name and email, say numbers from 0 to 1000, and understand a short Canadian message.

THE SITUATION

You are new in Canada. Before words and grammar, you need the ear and the mouth: how French sounds, how it is written, and how to say names and numbers, because on the phone, in a clinic and in an office, people ask you to spell your name and read out your numbers.

In Canada French is an official language of Canada. You will hear two accents: the France accent and the Québec accent. This stage teaches the standard sounds, and shows you where Québec French is different.

0.1 How French works

French uses the same letters as English, but the letters often make different sounds. The good news: French spelling follows rules, and the rules are very regular. You will learn them one group at a time.

Three big ideas

- **Spelling is not sound.** Learn to hear first, then read.
- **The last letter is often silent.** *petit* (small) is said puh-TEE. The t is written, but you do not say it.
- **Every syllable counts.** English stresses one syllable (*PHO-to-graph*). French gives each syllable almost the same length and force, with a small lift only on the last syllable of a group of words.

Tip You already read French every day in Canada: on road signs, packages and shop doors. Now learn how those words really sound.

Words you already half know

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
sortie	sohR-TEE	exit	La sortie est à gauche. The exit is on the left.
entrée	ah(n)-TRAY	entrance	L'entrée est ici. The entrance is here.
arrêt	ah-RAY	stop	Arrêt d'autobus. Bus stop.
ouvert	oo-VEHR	open	Le magasin est ouvert. The store is open.
fermé	fehR-MAY	closed	La banque est fermée. The bank is closed.
hôtel	oh-TEL	hotel	L'hôtel est ouvert. The hotel is open.
restaurant	rehs-toh-RAH(N)	restaurant	Le restaurant est fermé. The restaurant is closed.
banque	bah(n)k	bank	La banque est là. The bank is there.
pharmacie	fahR-mah-SEE	pharmacy	La pharmacie est fermée. The pharmacy is closed.
hôpital	oh-pee-TAHL	hospital	L'hôpital est ici. The hospital is here.

Watch out In *arrêt*, *ouvert*, *restaurant* and *petit* the last letter t is silent. In *hôtel* and *hôpital* the h is silent. Read the guide, not the spelling.

READING 0.1

What does the sign say?

Read each sign. Choose the best meaning.

SORTIE

1. Where do you go?

A Out
B In
C To the bank
D To the bus

ARRÊT

2. What do you do?

A Turn left
B Stop
C Go faster
D Park

FERMÉ

3. What is the situation?

A The shop is open
B The shop is far
C The shop is closed
D The shop is new

ENTRÉE

4. What is this?

A The exit
B The way in
C The price
D The bus stop

0.2 The alphabet and spelling your name

In Canada people ask you to spell your name all the time: on the phone with Service Canada, at a clinic, with a landlord, on a form. The French alphabet has the same 26 letters. Only the **names** of the letters are different. Learn them first, because everything else (names, emails, postal codes) uses them.

The 26 letters

LETTER	SAY IT	LETTER	SAY IT	LETTER	SAY IT
A	ah	J	zhee	S	ess
B	bay	K	kah	T	tay
C	say	L	ell	U	ü
D	day	M	emm	V	vay
E	uh	N	enn	W	doo-bluh-VAY
F	eff	O	oh	X	eeks
G	zhay	P	pay	Y	ee-GREK
H	ahsh	Q	kü	Z	zed
I	ee	R	ehR		

Tip for the hard ones. *G* is zhay (not "gee"). *J* is zhee (not "jay"). *E* is uh, *I* is ee. *W* is "double V" in French. *Y* is "i grec" (Greek i).

Words you need when you spell

Spelling words

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
Comment ça s'écrit ?	koh-mah(n) sah say-KREE	How do you spell that?	Comment ça s'écrit, Haddad ? How is Haddad spelled?
Ça s'écrit…	sah say-KREE	It is spelled…	Ça s'écrit T-R-E-M-B-L-A-Y. It is spelled T-R-E-M-B-L-A-Y.
Pouvez-vous répéter ?	poo-vay-VOO ray-pay-TAY	Can you repeat?	Pardon, pouvez-vous répéter ? Sorry, can you repeat?
deux L	duh ell	double L (two Ls)	Mallette : M-A-deux L-E-deux T-E. Mallette (a name): M-A-two L-E-two T-E.
un accent aigu	uh(n)n ahk-SAH(N) ay-GÜ	an acute accent (é)	Le é a un accent aigu. The é has an acute accent.
un trait d'union	uh(n) tray dü-nee-OH(N)	a hyphen (-)	Sainte-Anne a un trait d'union. Sainte-Anne has a hyphen.
arobase	ah-roh-BAHZ	the @ sign	sam, arobase, exemple, point c-a. sam, at, example, dot c-a.
point	pwa(n)	dot (.)	exemple, point c-a. example, dot c-a.
courriel	koo-ree-EL	email (Canada)	Mon courriel est sam@exemple.ca. My email is sam@example.ca.

In Canada In Canada the word for email is **courriel**. In France you hear **mail** or **e-mail**. For .ca say "point c-a" (point say-ah). Hyphens and dots are normal in names and addresses: say **trait d'union** and **point**.

On the phone

Samira calls a clinic to make an appointment.

Clinique Bonjour, clinique Sainte-Anne.
Hello, Sainte-Anne clinic.

Samira Bonjour. Je m'appelle Samira Haddad.
Hello. My name is Samira Haddad.

Clinique Comment ça s'écrit, Haddad ?
How is Haddad spelled?

Samira Ça s'écrit H-A-D-D-A-D. Deux D.
It is spelled H-A-D-D-A-D. Two Ds.

Clinique Merci, madame.
Thank you, madam.

EXERCISE 0.2A

Say the letters

Say each name out loud, letter by letter, in French. Then write the French names of the letters in your notebook.

1. SAM
2. LÉA (say the letters only)
3. MARC
4. JULIE
5. TREMBLAY
6. QUÉBEC

LISTENING 0.2

Spelled names

You hear a person spell their name once. Choose the name.

1. What is the name?

A Diallo **B** Dialo
C Dilao **D** Diello

2. What is the first name?

A Ava **B** Awa
C Aya **D** Ana

3. What is the last name?

A Gagnon **B** Gannon
C Gaignon **D** Gagnan

4. What is the end of the email?

A .com **B** .ca
C .fr **D** .org

SPEAKING 0.2S

Say your own name

Say: *Je m'appelle …* Then spell your family name in French, letter by letter. Say your email using **arobase** and **point**. Record yourself and listen.

- Say each letter clearly with a very small pause.
- Practise your own name until you can say it without thinking.

0.3 Accent marks

Accents are part of the spelling. Some change the sound. Some only change the spelling. You must write them correctly, because *a* and *à* are different words, and *ou* and *où* are different words.

The accents

MARK	ON	WHAT IT DOES	EXAMPLE
é (acute)	é	sound ay	été (summer): ay-TAY
è, ê (grave, circumflex)	è ê	sound eh	père (father): pehR · fête (party): feht
ë	ë	say the e separately	Noël: noh-EL

à, â	à â	sound ah (no change)	là (there): lah · âge (age): ahzh
ù, û	ù û	sound ü or oo, no change	où (where): oo · sûr (sure): sür
ô	ô	sound oh	hôtel: oh-TEL
î, ï	î ï	sound ee	île (island): eel · maïs (corn): mah-EES
ç (cedilla)	ç	c sounds like s	garçon (boy): gahR-SOH(N) · ça: sah
œ	œ	sound uh	sœur (sister): suhR · œuf (egg): uhf

Watch out **é** and **è** are two different sounds. *été* is ay-TAY. *mère* is mehR. *a* (has) and *à* (to, at) are different words. *ou* (or) and *où* (where) are different words.

In Canada Accents are everywhere in Canadian names: **Montréal**, **Québec**, **Trois-Rivières**, **Gaspésie**, rue **Sainte-Catherine**. In French, capital letters keep their accents: **À**, **É**.

Accent pairs and place names

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
Montréal	moh(n)-ray-AHL	Montréal	J'habite à Montréal. I live in Montréal.
Québec	kay-BEK	Québec	Montréal et Québec. Montréal and Québec.
français	frah(n)-SEH	French	Je parle français. I speak French.
où	oo	where	Où est la sortie ? Where is the exit?
ou	oo	or	Café ou thé ? Coffee or tea?
à	ah	to, at	Il est à Montréal. He is in Montréal.
a	ah	has	Il a un chat. He has a cat.
là	lah	there	Le café est là. The coffee is there.
la	lah	the (feminine)	La pharmacie est là. The pharmacy is there.
très	treh	very	Très bien. Very well.

EXERCISE 0.3A

Choose the right word

Write the correct word: *a* or *à*, *ou* or *où*.

1. Il ___ un livre. (He has a book.)
2. Je vais ___ Montréal. (I am going to Montréal.)
3. ___ est la banque ? (Where is the bank?)
4. Thé ___ café ? (Tea or coffee?)

0.4 The core vowels

French has 16 vowel sounds. Start with the ones you hear most. Say each pair out loud. Keep your mouth shape still while you say a vowel: French vowels do not glide like English ones (say *oh*, not *oh-oo*).

Vowels

SPELLING	SAY IT	EXAMPLE	MEANING
a	ah	papa (pah-PAH)	dad
é, er, ez (end of word)	ay	café (kah-FAY), parler (pahR-LAY)	coffee, to speak
è, ê, ai, ei, e + two consonants	eh	mère (mehR), mais (meh), belle (bel)	mother, but, beautiful

e (small, in the middle or end)	uh	le (luh), petit (puh-TEE), je (zhuh)	the, small, I
i, y	ee	ici (ee-SEE), il (eel)	here, he
o, ô, au, eau	oh	chose (shohz), chaud (shoh), beau (boh), eau (oh)	thing, hot, beautiful, water
oi	wah	moi (mwah), trois (trwah)	me, three
ou	oo	vous (voo), jour (zhoor), pour (poor)	you, day, for
eu, œu	uh (round lips)	deux (duh), peur (puhR), fleur (fluhR)	two, fear, flower
u	ü	tu (tü), rue (Rü), sûr (sür)	you, street, sure

Tip The **e** with no accent has three jobs. At the end of a word it is silent (*petite* ends with the t sound). In a small word (*le, je, me*) it is **uh**. Before two consonants it is **eh** (*elle, belle*).

EXERCISE 0.4A

Read aloud, then sort

Say each word aloud. Write the sound of the underlined vowel: ah, ay, eh, uh, ee, oh, oo, wah or ü.

1. mère
2. vous
3. moi
4. tu
5. eau
6. café

LISTENING 0.4

Which word did you hear?

You hear one word. Choose the word.

1. Which number?

A trois
B tout
C tu
D toi

2. Which word?

A bu
B beau
C bout
D bœuf

3. Which word?

A vu
B veux
C vous
D vue

4. Which word?

A mer
B mère
C mari
D mur

0.5 u or ou? The rounded vowels

This is the first sound that is really new for English speakers. **u** and **ou** are different, and they change the meaning of a word.

- **ou** = oo, as in *food*. Lips round and push forward. *tout* (all): too.
- **u** = ü. Say *ee* and, without moving your tongue, round your lips as for *oo*. *tu* (you): tü.
- **eu** = lips round, tongue forward, like *her* with a rounded mouth. *deux* (two): duh.

Minimal pairs: one letter, different word

U (Ü)	OU (OO)	EU (UH)
tu (you)	tout (all)	—
rue (street)	roue (wheel)	—
dessus (on top)	dessous (underneath)	—
su (known)	sous (under)	—
—	doux (soft)	deux (two)
—	pour (for)	peur (fear)

—	fou (crazy)	feu (fire)

In Canada In Québec, short **u**, **i** and **ou** can become more relaxed: *petite* and *lune* sound slightly different from France. You will hear it in the app. For the exam, the clear standard sounds are what you produce.

LISTENING 0.5

u or ou?

You hear a word. Choose the word you heard.

1. Which word?

A tu
B tout
C toux
D tue

2. Which word?

A roue
B rue
C rouge
D roux

3. Which word?

A su
B sous
C sur
D sou

4. Which number?

A doux
B deux
C dix
D dos

SPEAKING 0.5S

Pairs out loud

Say these pairs. Make the two sounds really different: *tu, tout · rue, roue · dessus, dessous.* Then say *Il est sous la table* (He is under the table).

- Look in a mirror: for ü and oo your lips are rounded. For ü your tongue is forward, for oo it is back.

0.6 Nasal vowels

When a vowel is followed by **n** or **m** at the end of a syllable, the vowel becomes **nasal**: the air goes through your nose and you do **not** say the n. There are four nasal vowels. Pinch your nose: the sound should buzz.

Four nasal vowels

SPELLING	SAY IT	EXAMPLE	MEANING
an, en, am, em	ah(n)	enfant (ah(n)-fah(n)), dans (dah(n)), temps (tah(n))	child, in, time
on, om	oh(n)	bon (boh(n)), nom (noh(n)), maison (meh-zoh(n))	good, name, house
in, ain, ein, im, aim	a(n)	vin (va(n)), pain (pa(n)), plein (pla(n))	wine, bread, full
un, um	uh(n)	un (uh(n)), lundi (luh(n)-DEE)	one, Monday

Say the three columns slowly

AN / EN	ON	IN / AIN
banc (bah(n))	bon (boh(n))	bain (ba(n))
vent (vah(n))	vont (voh(n))	vin (va(n))
quand (kah(n))	qu'on (koh(n))	quinze (ka(n)z)

Watch out The vowel is **not** nasal when **n** or **m** is doubled or followed by a vowel: *bon* is boh(n), but *bonne* is bun. *un* is uh(n), but *une* is ün. *vin* is va(n), but *vinaigre* is vee-NEHgR.

In Canada Québec French has these nasals too, with a slightly different quality: *maintenant* (now) and *quinze* (fifteen) sound a little different from France. Both are correct.

Nasal vowels in real words

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
français	frah(n)-SEH	French	Bonjour, je parle français. Hello, I speak French.

enfant	ah(n)-FAH(N)	child	L'enfant est là. The child is there.
bon	boh(n)	good	Bon appétit ! Enjoy your meal!
bonne	bun	good (feminine)	Bonne journée ! Have a good day!
maintenant	ma(n)t-NAH(N)	now	Je suis ici maintenant. I am here now.
quinze	ka(n)z	fifteen	Il a quinze ans. He is fifteen.
pain	pa(n)	bread	Le pain est bon. The bread is good.
lundi	luh(n)-DEE	Monday	C'est lundi. It is Monday.

LISTENING 0.6

Nasal vowels

You hear a word. Choose the word you heard.

1. Which word?

A banc **B** bon
C bain **D** beau

2. Which word?

A vin **B** vont
C vent **D** vous

3. Which word?

A pan **B** pont
C pain **D** pas

4. Which number?

A cinq **B** quinze
C quatorze **D** seize

0.7 Consonants and silent letters

Most French consonants are like English ones. The surprises are the **silent final letters** and a few letter groups.

The big rule: the last consonant is usually silent

petit (puh-TEE), *grand* (grah(n)), *vous* (voo), *Paris* (pah-REE), *trop* (troh), *beaucoup* (boh-KOO), *chez* (shay). The **c, r, f, l** are often said at the end, so remember **CaReFuL**: *avec* (ah-VEK), *bonjour* (boh(n)-ZHOOR), *neuf* (nuhf), *sel* (sel). There are exceptions: *-er* verbs end in ay (*parler* is pahR-LAY) and *-ier* words too.

Letters that surprise English speakers

LETTERS	SAY IT	EXAMPLE	MEANING
c before a, o, u	k	café, copie, cuisine	coffee, copy, kitchen
c before e, i, y; ç	s	ceci (suh-SEE), ça (sah), garçon	this, that, boy
g before a, o, u	g (hard)	gare (gahR), gommer	station
g before e, i, y	zh	girafe (zhee-RAHF), âge (ahzh)	giraffe, age
gu before e, i	g (hard)	guitare (gee-TAHR)	guitar
qu	k	qui (kee), quatre (KAHtr)	who, four
ch	sh	chat (shah), chose (shohz)	cat, thing
gn	ny	montagne (moh(n)-TAHNY)	mountain
j	zh	jour (zhoor), je (zhuh)	day, I
s between two vowels	z	rose (rohz), poison (pwah-ZOH(N))	rose, poison

ss	s	poisson (pwah-SOH(N))	fish
h	silent	homme (ohm), heure (uhR), hôtel	man, hour, hotel
th	t	thé (tay)	tea
ph	f	photo (foh-TOH), pharmacie	photo, pharmacy

Watch out **poisson** (fish, double s, pwah-SOH(N)) and **poison** (poison, single s between vowels, pwah-ZOH(N)) differ by one letter. Double s is s. Single s between two vowels is z.

In Canada In Québec, **t** and **d** before **i** or **u** are often said with a small hiss: *tu* sounds close to "tsü" and *dire* close to "dzeer". That is a normal Québec feature. In your own speech, the standard t and d are always understood, and that is what you practise for the exam.

EXERCISE 0.7A

Say it, then write the sound

Write how each word is said.

1. chat
2. quatre
3. gare
4. girafe
5. montagne
6. thé

LISTENING 0.7

Listen carefully

You hear one word. Choose the word.

1. Which word?

A poison **B** poisson
C possible **D** passion

2. Which word?

A chat **B** chaud
C chez **D** chose

3. Which word?

A gars **B** garçon
C gaz **D** gare

4. Which number?

A cent **B** quatre
C cinq **D** quinze

0.8 The French r

The French **r** is not made with the tongue tip like in English. It is made **in the back of the throat**, a soft friction, a little like clearing your throat very gently or a quiet gargle.

How to find it

- Say a long **ah**. Now say **g-g-g-ah**. Feel the back of your tongue touch the soft palate.
- Say **ha**, then make the h rough and soft in the throat: **hRa**.
- Keep the tongue tip down, touching your bottom front teeth, and do not move it.

Practise the r at the start, in the middle, and at the end

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
rue	Rü	street	La rue Sainte-Catherine. Sainte-Catherine Street.
rouge	RoozH	red	C'est rouge. It is red.
merci	mehR-SEE	thank you	Merci, madame. Thank you, madam.

par	pahR	by, through	Par ici. This way.
mer	mehR	sea	La mer est grande. The sea is big.
sœur	suhR	sister	La sœur de Marc est là. Marc's sister is there.
bonjour	boh(n)-ZHOOR	hello	Bonjour, madame. Hello, madam.
regarder	Ruh-gahR-DAY	to look at	Je regarde la sortie. I look at the exit.

In Canada The r varies a lot in Québec: it can be more rolled or more relaxed depending on the region. A clear standard r is enough for the exam. Do not worry about getting it perfect on day one.

SPEAKING 0.8S

R practice

Say slowly, then faster: *rue, rouge, merci, par, bonjour, regarder*. Say *Bonjour, merci, au revoir* three times. Record yourself.

- If your r sounds like an English r, relax your tongue and keep the tip against your bottom teeth.
- Do not push. Soft and in the throat is better than hard.

0.9 Liaison, enchaînement and élision

French speakers join words together. This is why spoken French feels fast. There are three kinds of joining.

1. Liaison: a silent last consonant is said before a vowel

Liaison

WRITTEN	SAY IT	MEANING
les amis	lay-zah-MEE	the friends
un ami	uh(n)-nah-MEE	a friend (male)
vous êtes	voo-ZET	you are
ils ont	eel-ZOH(N)	they have
c'est un homme	seh-tuh(n)-NOHM	it is a man

Watch out Never make a liaison **after** the word **et** (and): *un garçon et un homme* has no link between *et* and *un*.

2. Enchaînement: a said consonant links to the next vowel

il est ici is not eel-eh-ee-SEE with gaps. It is **ee-leh-tee-SEE**: the l of *il* and the t of *est* attach to the next vowel. *elle a* is **eh-lah**. *une amie* is **ü-nah-MEE**.

3. Élision: the vowel disappears before another vowel

Élision

WRITTEN	SAY IT	MEANING
le + ami = l'ami	lah-MEE	the friend
je + ai = j'ai	zhay	I have
ce + est = c'est	seh	it is
que + il = qu'il	keel	that he
de + eau = d'eau	doh	of water
je + habite = j'habite	zhah-BEET	I live

In Canada In fast Canadian speech you will hear **je suis** become “chu” and **tu es** become “t'es”. This is informal. You understand it when you hear it, but in the exam writing and in careful speech use **je suis** and **tu es**.

LISTENING 0.9

Joined words

You hear a short phrase. Choose what you heard.

1. Which phrase?

A les amis
B le ami
C les mis
D l'ami

2. Which phrase?

A vous êtes
B vous être
C vous aites
D vous elles

3. Where does the speaker live?

A Toronto
B Montréal
C Ottawa
D Québec

4. What is it?

A a woman
B a man
C a child
D a friend

0.10 Numbers 0 to 20

Numbers are the heart of the first TCF questions: platform numbers, prices, phone numbers, times. Learn them by ear first. Say each one aloud.

0 to 20

#	FRENCH	SAY IT	#	FRENCH	SAY IT
0	zéro	zay-ROH	11	onze	oh(n)z
1	un, une	uh(n), ün	12	douze	dooz
2	deux	duh	13	treize	trehz
3	trois	trwah	14	quatorze	kah-TOHRZ
4	quatre	KAHtr	15	quinze	ka(n)z
5	cinq	sa(n)k	16	seize	sehz
6	six	sees	17	dix-sept	dee-SET
7	sept	set	18	dix-huit	dee-ZWEET
8	huit	weet	19	dix-neuf	deez-NUHF
9	neuf	nuhf	20	vingt	va(n)
10	dix	dees			

Watch out Before a word that starts with a consonant, **six**, **dix** and **huit** lose their last sound: *six livres* (see LEEvr), *dix livres* (dee LEEvr), *huit jours* (wee ZHOOR). Before a vowel they link: *six ans* (see-ZAH(N)), *dix ans* (dee-ZAH(N)), *neuf ans* (nuh-VAH(N)).

In real Canadian life

WHAT	HOW YOU SAY IT
911	neuf, un, un (nuhf, uh(n), uh(n))
Phone 514 555 0143	cinq-un-quatre, cinq-cinq-cinq, zéro-un-quatre-trois
Bus 24	l'autobus vingt-quatre
Postal code H2X 1Y4	H, deux, X, un, Y, quatre (letters and digits)
$5	cinq dollars

In Canada In Canada, phone numbers are said in short groups. You will hear **cinq-un-quatre** for 514 (Montréal), **six-un-trois** for 613 (Ottawa), **quatre-un-six** for 416 (Toronto). Postal codes mix letters and digits, so your alphabet from 0.2 is useful here.

EXERCISE 0.10A

Numbers to French

Write each number in French words.

1. 3

2. 7
3. 12
4. 15
5. 18
6. 20

LISTENING 0.10

Numbers

You hear a number or a short sentence once. Choose the answer.

1. Which platform?

A Platform 5
B Platform 8
C Platform 18
D Platform 3

2. How much?

A $4
B $14
C $40
D $44

3. Which bus?

A Bus 6
B Bus 16
C Bus 60
D Bus 17

4. What are the first three digits?

A 5-4-1
B 5-1-4
C 4-1-5
D 5-1-1

0.11 Numbers 20 to 1000 and beyond

After 20 the system is regular up to 69. Then it changes: French counts 70 as **sixty-ten**, 80 as **four-twenties**, and 90 as **four-twenties-ten**. This is true in **both France and Québec**. (Belgium and Switzerland use *septante* and *nonante*, so you may hear these from time to time, but you do not need to say them.)

Counting up

#	FRENCH	SAY IT
20	vingt	va(n)
21	vingt et un	va(n)-tay-UH(N)
22	vingt-deux	va(n)-DUH
30	trente	trah(n)t
31	trente et un	trah(n)-tay-UH(N)
40	quarante	kah-RAH(N)T
50	cinquante	sa(n)-KAH(N)T
60	soixante	swah-SAH(N)T
70	soixante-dix	swah-sah(n)t-DEES
71	soixante et onze	swah-sah(n)-tay-OH(N)Z
72	soixante-douze	swah-sah(n)t-DOOZ
79	soixante-dix-neuf	swah-sah(n)t-deez-NUHF
80	quatre-vingts	kah-truh-VA(N)
81	quatre-vingt-un	kah-truh-va(n)-TUH(N)
90	quatre-vingt-dix	kah-truh-va(n)-DEES
91	quatre-vingt-onze	kah-truh-va(n)-TOH(N)Z
99	quatre-vingt-dix-neuf	kah-truh-va(n)-deez-NUHF
100	cent	sah(n)
200	deux cents	duh sah(n)

201	deux cent un	duh sah(n)-TUH(N)
1000	mille	meel
2026	deux mille vingt-six	duh meel va(n)-SEES

- **et un** is used for 21, 31, 41, 51, 61 and 71 (*vingt et un*, *soixante et onze*), but **not** for 81 and 91 (*quatre-vingt-un*, *quatre-vingt-onze*).
- **quatre-vingts** takes an s only when nothing follows (80). With another number, no s: *quatre-vingt-deux*. The same for **cent**: *deux cents*, but *deux cent trois*.
- **mille** never takes an s. *Trois mille* (3000).

Prices, rent, years

WRITTEN	YOU SAY
12,50 $	douze dollars cinquante (or just: douze cinquante)
1 200 $ (rent)	mille deux cents dollars
1990	mille neuf cent quatre-vingt-dix
2026	deux mille vingt-six
15 %	quinze pour cent

In Canada In Canada the dollar sign comes **after** the number: **12,50 $**, with a **comma** for the decimals and a **space** for thousands: **1 200 $**. Taxes are shown as **TPS** (GST) and **TVQ** (QST, in Québec), so you will often hear *plus taxes*.

EXERCISE 0.11A

Numbers to French

Write each number in French words.

1. 21
2. 45
3. 72
4. 80
5. 95
6. 1 200 $ (dollars)

LISTENING 0.11

Prices and numbers

You hear a short sentence once. Choose the answer.

1. How much is the rent?

A $120 **B** $1 200
C $1 020 **D** $12 000

2. How much?

A $62 **B** $72
C $82 **D** $92

3. Which number?

A 85 **B** 95
C 75 **D** 90

4. Which year?

A 2016 **B** 2020
C 2026 **D** 2062

0.12 Rhythm, intonation and questions

Melody is part of meaning in French. Two simple rules cover most of what you need.

Melody

SENTENCE TYPE	MELODY	EXAMPLE
Statement	falls at the end ↘	Je parle français. ↘
Yes/no question	rises at the end ↗	Tu parles français ? ↗

Question with a question word (où, quand, comment…)	falls ↘	Où habites-tu ? ↘
List	rises on each item, falls on the last	Du pain ↗, du lait ↗, des pommes ↘.

Rhythm. Cut the sentence into small groups. Each syllable has the same length. The last syllable of each group is a little longer and higher. *Je m'appelle Sam.* = zhuh-mah-PELL-sam. *Tu parles français ?* = tü-pahrl-frah(n)-SEH ↗.

In Canada In Québec, a yes/no question often ends with a small word *-tu*: *Tu viens-tu ?* (Are you coming?). It is informal speech. In the exam use *Tu viens ?* or *Est-ce que tu viens ?*.

EXERCISE 0.12A

Falling or rising?

Write ↘ (statement or question word) or ↗ (yes/no question).

1. Il est canadien.
2. Vous êtes canadien ?
3. Comment vous appelez-vous ?
4. Elle habite à Toronto.
5. Tu parles anglais ?

LISTENING 0.12

Statement or question?

You hear a sentence once. Is it a statement or a question?

1. What did you hear?

A a statement
B a yes/no question
C a command
D a greeting

2. What did you hear?

A a question
B a statement
C a greeting
D a name

3. What does the person want to know?

A Where the station is
B What time it is
C The price
D The name

SPEAKING 0.12S

Melody practice

Say each sentence twice, once as a statement and once as a question: *Il parle français.* · *Il parle français ?* Record yourself and compare.

- Exaggerate the melody at first. Then make it smaller.

0.13 Hear it in Canada: a first listening

Time to put it together. Listen to each message **once**, as in the real test. Then answer. Remember: never leave a question empty.

Two vocabularies, one language

FRANCE	CANADA
mail, e-mail	courriel
week-end	fin de semaine (also week-end)
épicerie, supérette	dépanneur (Québec)
petit déjeuner, déjeuner, dîner	déjeuner, dîner, souper
de rien	bienvenue (you're welcome)
faire les courses	faire l'épicerie, magasiner (to shop)

Tip Do not panic if a word is different. Both are French. The test accepts standard French and uses both accents in the audio.

LISTENING 0.13

A first Canadian listening

You hear each message once. Choose the answer.

1. When is the appointment?

A Monday at 9:30
B Monday at 9:13
C Tuesday at 9:30
D Monday at 3:30

2. Which platform?

A Platform 2
B Platform 3
C Platform 13
D Platform 4

3. When does the store close?

A At 11 pm
B At 10 pm
C At 2 pm
D It is closed

4. What is the area code?

A 416
B 514
C 613
D 911

SPEAKING 0.13S

Your first Canadian phone message

Record a short message: say your name, spell your family name, say your phone number in groups. For example: *Bonjour, je m'appelle Sam Tremblay. T-R-E-M-B-L-A-Y. Mon numéro est le cinq, un, quatre...*

- Speak slowly. Leave a short pause between groups of digits.

Stage 0 checklist

- I can say the 26 letter names and spell my name.
- I know é and è are different, and what ç does.
- I can say a, e, i, o, u, ou, eu, oi without sliding.
- I can tell u from ou, and say the four nasal vowels.
- I know most last letters are silent, and the CaReFuL exceptions.
- I can make a usable French r.
- I can say numbers to 100 and read a price.
- I know a question goes up, a statement goes down.

UNIT 1

1

Introduce yourself

AFTER THIS UNIT YOU CAN

Say my name, where I live, where I am from and what languages I speak, greet people politely, and understand the same from others.

THE SITUATION

Your first day at a French class in Ottawa, a call to a clinic, a form at a service desk. In every one of them, the first thing people ask is who you are.

In Canada Canada has two official languages, so at a government desk you may hear *Bonjour, hello* in the same breath. Answering in French is always welcome.

In Canada In Québec, people often greet customers with a friendly **Bonjour !** both when you come in and when you leave a shop.

1.1 Words: greetings and the basics

Group 1: say hello

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
bonjour	boh(n)-ZHOOR	hello, good day	Bonjour, madame. Hello, madam.
bonsoir	boh(n)-SWAHR	good evening	Bonsoir, monsieur. Good evening, sir.
salut	sah-LÜ	hi (friends and family)	Salut, Marc ! Hi, Marc!
allô	ah-LOH	hello (casual, phone)	Allô ? C'est Léa. Hello? It's Léa.
oui	wee	yes	Oui, c'est ça. Yes, that's right.
non	noh(n)	no	Non, elle est canadienne. No, she is Canadian.
monsieur	muh-SYUH	sir, Mr., man	Bonjour, monsieur. Hello, sir.
madame	mah-DAHM	madam, Mrs., woman	Bonjour, madame. Hello, madam.
enchanté / enchantée	ah(n)-shah(n)-TAY	nice to meet you	Enchanté, Sam. Nice to meet you, Sam.
et	ay	and	Marc et Léa. Marc and Léa.
le soir	luh swahr	evening	Il est sept heures du soir. It is seven in the evening.

In Canada In Canada, **allô** is a normal casual hello, especially on the phone. In France you hear *allô* mostly on the phone too. Use **bonjour** with anyone you do not know.

Group 2: who is speaking?

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
je	zhuh	I	Je suis Sam. I am Sam.
tu	tü	you (one friend, family, child)	Tu es Léa. You are Léa.
il	eel	he, it	Il est canadien. He is Canadian.
elle	el	she, it	Elle est canadienne. She is Canadian.
on	oh(n)	we, one (informal)	On parle français. We speak French.
nous	noo	we	Nous sommes à Ottawa. We are in Ottawa.
vous	voo	you (formal, or more than one)	Vous êtes madame Diallo ? Are you Mrs. Diallo?
ils	eel	they (masculine or mixed)	Ils sont canadiens. They are Canadian.
elles	el	they (feminine only)	Elles sont canadiennes. They are Canadian.
être	EHtr	to be	Je suis, tu es, il est. I am, you are, he is.

moi / toi	mwah / twah	me / you (stressed forms)	**Et toi ?** And you?

Group 3: names and people

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
le nom	luh noh(n)	last name, name	**Nom : Tremblay.** Last name: Tremblay.
le prénom	luh pray-NOH(N)	first name	**Prénom : Sam.** First name: Sam.
le nom de famille	luh noh(n) duh fah-MEEY	family name	**Nom de famille : Tremblay.** Family name: Tremblay.
l'homme (m.)	lohm	man	**Un homme parle.** A man is speaking.
la femme	lah fahm	woman, wife	**Une femme arrive.** A woman arrives.
le garçon	luh gahR-SOH(N)	boy	**Le garçon est canadien.** The boy is Canadian.
la fille	lah feey	girl, daughter	**La fille est canadienne.** The girl is Canadian.
l'ami / l'amie	lah-MEE	friend (m. / f.)	**Marc est un ami.** Marc is a friend.
la personne	lah pehR-SUN	person	**La personne est ici.** The person is here.
l'enfant	lah(n)-FAH(N)	child	**L'enfant parle français.** The child speaks French.

Watch out **nom** means both *name* and *last name*. On a form in Canada you will see **Nom** (last name) and **Prénom** (first name). Do not mix them up.

Group 4: countries

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
le Canada	luh kah-nah-DAH	Canada	**C'est le Canada.** This is Canada.
la France	lah frah(n)s	France	**Elle est française.** She is French.
le Québec	luh kay-BEK	Québec	**Elle est québécoise.** She is from Québec.
l'Inde (f.)	la(n)d	India	**Je viens de l'Inde.** I come from India.
les Philippines (f.)	lay fee-lee-PEEN	the Philippines	**Il est philippin.** He is Filipino.
la Chine	lah sheen	China	**Je viens de la Chine.** I come from China.
le Maroc	luh mah-ROK	Morocco	**Il est marocain.** He is Moroccan.
l'Algérie (f.)	lahl-zhay-REE	Algeria	**Elle est algérienne.** She is Algerian.
Haïti (m.)	ah-ee-TEE	Haiti	**Il est haïtien.** He is Haitian.
la Colombie	lah koh-loh(n)-BEE	Colombia	**Elle est colombienne.** She is Colombian.
le pays	luh pay-EE	country	**Le Canada est un pays.** Canada is a country.

la ville	lah veel	city, town	Ottawa est une ville. Ottawa is a city.
la nationalité	lah nah-syoh-nah-lee-TAY	nationality	Nationalité : canadienne. Nationality: Canadian.

Group 5: nationalities (masculine and feminine)

COUNTRY	HE IS...	SHE IS...
le Canada	canadien (kah-nah-DYA(N))	canadienne (kah-nah-DYEN)
la France	français (frah(n)-SEH)	française (frah(n)-SEHZ)
le Québec	québécois (kay-bay-KWAH)	québécoise (kay-bay-KWAHZ)
l'Inde	indien (a(n)-DYA(N))	indienne (a(n)-DYEN)
les Philippines	philippin (fee-lee-PA(N))	philippine (fee-lee-PEEN)
la Chine	chinois (shee-NWAH)	chinoise (shee-NWAHZ)
le Maroc	marocain (mah-roh-KA(N))	marocaine (mah-roh-KEHN)
l'Algérie	algérien (ahl-zhay-RYA(N))	algérienne (ahl-zhay-RYEN)
Haïti	haïtien (ah-ee-SYA(N))	haïtienne (ah-ee-SYEN)
la Colombie	colombien (koh-loh(n)-BYA(N))	colombienne (koh-loh(n)-BYEN)

Tip In writing, a nationality is **not** capitalised in French: *un homme canadien*, *une femme française*. In speech, the feminine form **says the last consonant**: *canadien* ends in a nasal vowel, *canadienne* ends in the n sound.

Group 6: languages and two key verbs

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
le français	luh frah(n)-SEH	French (language)	Je parle français. I speak French.
l'anglais	lah(n)-GLEH	English (language)	Je parle anglais. I speak English.
l'espagnol	lehs-pah-NYOL	Spanish	Je parle espagnol. I speak Spanish.
l'arabe	lah-RAHB	Arabic	Elle parle arabe et français. She speaks Arabic and French.
le hindi	luh a(n)-DEE	Hindi	Il parle hindi et anglais. He speaks Hindi and English.
le mandarin	luh mah(n)-dah-RA(N)	Mandarin	Je parle un peu mandarin. I speak a little Mandarin.
la langue / les langues	lah lah(n)g / lay lah(n)g	language / languages	Le français est une langue. French is a language.
parler	pahR-LAY	to speak	Je parle français. I speak French.
habiter	ah-bee-TAY	to live (in a place)	J'habite à Ottawa. I live in Ottawa.
un peu	uh(n) puh	a little	Je parle un peu français. I speak a little French.

1.2 Phrases: the words in blocks

Learn these as whole blocks, exactly as you hear them. Say each one out loud three times. The grammar behind them comes in section 1.3.

Introduce yourself

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
Je m'appelle Sam.	zhuh mah-PEL sam	My name is Sam.	
Comment vous appelez-vous ?	koh-mah(n) voo zah-puh-LAY-voo	What is your name? (formal)	

Comment tu t'appelles ?	koh-mah(n) tü tah-PEL	What is your name? (friends)
Je suis canadien.	zhuh swee kah-nah-DYA(N)	I am Canadian. (a man)
Je suis canadienne.	zhuh swee kah-nah-DYEN	I am Canadian. (a woman)
Je parle français.	zhuh pahrl frah(n)-SEH	I speak French.
Je parle un peu anglais.	zhuh pahrl uh(n) puh ah(n)-GLEH	I speak a little English.
Vous parlez français ?	voo pahR-lay frah(n)-SEH	Do you speak French? (formal)
J'habite à Montréal.	zhah-BEET ah moh(n)-ray-AHL	I live in Montréal.
Je viens de l'Inde.	zhuh vya(n) duh la(n)d	I come from India.
D'où venez-vous ?	doo vuh-nay-VOO	Where are you from? (formal)
Et vous ?	ay VOO	And you? (formal)
Moi aussi.	mwah oh-SEE	Me too.
Enchanté. / Enchantée.	ah(n)-shah(n)-TAY	Nice to meet you.

SPEAKING 1.2S

Say it as a block

Cover the English. Say each French block out loud. If you cannot, say it again with the guide. Then replace *Sam*, *canadien*, *Montréal* and *l'Inde* with your own details.

- Say the whole block in one breath, evenly. Do not say words one by one.

1.3 Grammar: how the words connect

A. être: to be (g01)

être is the most important verb in French. It is irregular, so you learn each form. It says **who someone is** and **what someone is like**.

être (to be), present

PERSON	FORM	SAY IT	EXAMPLE
je	suis	swee	Je suis Sam.
tu	es	eh	Tu es canadien.
il / elle / on	est	eh	Elle est française.
nous	sommes	sum	Nous sommes à Ottawa.
vous	êtes	et	Vous êtes madame Diallo ?
ils / elles	sont	soh(n)	Ils sont canadiens.

Watch out *es* and *est* sound **exactly the same** (eh). *tu es* and *il est* differ only by the first word. Always listen for the pronoun. *vous êtes* has a z-link: voo-ZET.

B. The subject pronouns (g04)

Who is acting?

	SINGULAR	PLURAL
1st person	je (I)	nous (we) · on (we, informal)
2nd person	tu (you, informal)	vous (you, formal or plural)
3rd person	il (he) · elle (she)	ils (they, m. or mixed) · elles (they, f.)

je becomes **j'** before a vowel or a silent h (*j'habite*, *j'ai*). **ils** is used for a group that includes at least one man. In everyday speech, French speakers prefer **on** to mean *we*: *On parle français* = We speak French.

C. tu or vous? (g03)

French has two ways to say *you*. This is not decoration: using the wrong one can sound rude or strange.

USE TU	USE VOUS

friends and family	a stranger, a clerk, an official
children	someone older than you
classmates	your manager or teacher at first
people your own age, informally	more than one person, always

In Canada Québec uses **tu** more quickly than France. A shop clerk may say *tu* to you after five minutes, which is friendly and normal there. As a newcomer, **start with vous** and let the other person offer *tu*. In offices, clinics and government services, use **vous**.

D. -er verbs: parler, habiter, s'appeler (g09a)

Most French verbs end in **-er**. They are regular. Remove **-er**, then add the endings:

The first three persons (we, you-plural and they come in Unit 4)

PERSON	PARLER	HABITER	S'APPELER
je	je parle	j'habite	je m'appelle
tu	tu parles	tu habites	tu t'appelles
il / elle	il parle	elle habite	elle s'appelle

- The endings **-e, -es, -e** are **silent**: *parle*, *parles* and *parle* all sound the same (pahrl).
- Only the pronoun tells you who is speaking. This is the silent-letter rule from Stage 0.
- **s'appeler** literally means *to call oneself*. *Je m'appelle Sam* = I call myself Sam. The **m'** is *me* reduced (élision).

E. Nationalities: man and woman

A nationality is an adjective. It matches the person: add **-e** for a woman (*français* → *française*). Many end in **-ien** for a man and **-ienne** for a woman (*canadien* → *canadienne*). In **speech**, the feminine says the final consonant. In **writing**, you add the letters. The full rule comes in Unit 4.

EXERCISE 1.3A

Complete with être

Write the right form of *être*.

1. Je ___ Sam.
2. Tu ___ canadien.
3. Elle ___ française.
4. Nous ___ à Ottawa.
5. Vous ___ madame Diallo ?
6. Ils ___ canadiens.

EXERCISE 1.3B

tu or vous?

Write *tu* or *vous* for each person.

1. Your best friend.
2. An immigration officer.
3. Your new landlord.
4. A child at school.
5. Two classmates together.
6. Your sister.

EXERCISE 1.3C

Complete the verb

Write the right form of the verb in brackets.

1. Je (parler) ___ français.
2. Tu (habiter) ___ à Toronto.
3. Elle (s'appeler) ___ Nadia.
4. J' (habiter) ___ à Ottawa.
5. Il (parler) ___ anglais.
6. Tu (s'appeler) ___ comment ?

EXERCISE 1.3D

Masculine or feminine?

Write the correct nationality: a man or a woman.

1. Marc is from Canada. Il est ___.
2. Julie is from France. Elle est ___.
3. Karim is from Morocco. Il est ___.
4. Nadia is from Algeria. Elle est ___.
5. Priya is from India. Elle est ___.
6. Wei is from China. Il est ___.

1.4 Dialogue: at French class

The first day

A French class in Ottawa. Anna lives in Montréal and Sam lives in Toronto. They meet for the first time.

Anna Salut ! Je m'appelle Anna.
Hi! My name is Anna.

Sam Salut ! Je m'appelle Sam. Enchanté.
Hi! My name is Sam. Nice to meet you.

Anna Enchantée. J'habite à Montréal.
Nice to meet you. I live in Montréal.

Sam J'habite à Toronto. Je parle anglais.
I live in Toronto. I speak English.

Anna Tu parles français ?
Do you speak French?

Sam Oui. Je parle un peu français.
Yes. I speak a little French.

Anna Moi aussi. Tu es canadien ?
Me too. Are you Canadian?

Sam Oui, je suis canadien. Et toi ?
Yes, I am Canadian. And you?

Anna Je suis indienne. Je viens de l'Inde.
I am Indian. I come from India.

Tip **toi** is the stressed form of *tu*: *Et toi ?* means *And you?* (informal). The formal form is *Et vous ?*. The pair **moi / toi** is used after *et* and alone: *Moi aussi.*

At the counter

A service desk in a government office. The clerk uses vous.

Agent Bonjour, madame. Votre nom, s'il vous plaît ?
Hello, madam. Your name, please?

Mme Diallo Diallo. D-I-A-deux L-O.
Diallo. D-I-A-two L-O.

Agent Et votre prénom ?
And your first name?

Mme Diallo Awa. A-W-A.
Awa. A-W-A.

Agent Merci. Vous êtes canadienne ?
Thank you. Are you Canadian?

Mme Diallo Non, je suis haïtienne. J'habite à Gatineau.
No, I am Haitian. I live in Gatineau.

READING 1.4

Understand the dialogue

Read the second dialogue again. Choose the best answer.

1. Where does Awa Diallo live?

A Ottawa
B Gatineau
C Haiti
D Montréal

2. What does the clerk want first?

A Her country
B Her last name
C Her phone number
D Her language

3. What does Awa say about her nationality?

A She is Canadian
B She is Haitian
C She is French
D She is Moroccan

1.5 Story

Read the story slowly. Say each sentence out loud. In the app you can tap any word and hear Marie say it.

Before you read: words in the story

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
le couloir	luh koo-LWAHR	hallway	Le couloir est grand. The hallway is big.
la valise	lah vah-LEEZ	suitcase	La valise est petite. The suitcase is small.
sept heures	set uhR	seven o'clock	Il est sept heures. It is seven o'clock.
arriver	ah-ree-VAY	to arrive	Elle arrive. She arrives.
avec	ah-VEK	with	Marc parle avec Nadia. Marc is talking with Nadia.
dans	dah(n)	in	Marc est dans le couloir. Marc is in the hallway.
nouveau / nouvelle	noo-VOH / noo-VEL	new	Nadia est nouvelle. Nadia is new.
l'immeuble (m.)	la-MUHBL	apartment building	L'immeuble est grand. The building is big.
l'étage (m.)	lay-TAHZH	floor, storey	Nadia est à l'étage. Nadia is upstairs.
troisième	trwah-ZYEM	third	Le troisième étage. The third floor.
dit	dee	says (dire)	Marc dit : Bonjour. Marc says: Hello.
bienvenue	bya(n)-vuh-NÜ	welcome	Bienvenue au Canada ! Welcome to Canada!

STORY

Une nouvelle voisine

A new neighbour

Il est sept heures du soir.
It is seven in the evening.

Marc est dans le couloir.
Marc is in the hallway.

Une femme arrive avec une valise.
A woman arrives with a suitcase.

« Bonsoir ! Je m'appelle Nadia. »
"Good evening! My name is Nadia."

« Enchanté ! Je suis Marc. »
"Nice to meet you! I am Marc."

Nadia est nouvelle dans l'immeuble.
Nadia is new in the building.
In Canada, *immeuble* is the usual word for an apartment building.

Elle habite au troisième étage.
She lives on the third floor.

Elle parle français et anglais.
She speaks French and English.

Marc dit : « Bienvenue ! »

Marc says: "Welcome!"

In Canada, *bienvenue* is also how you say *you're welcome* after someone thanks you.

READING 1.5

Story questions

Choose the best answer.

1. What time is it at the start?

A Seven in the evening
B Seven in the morning
C Eight in the evening
D Six in the evening

2. Who is new in the building?

A Marc
B Nadia
C A man
D Nobody

3. Which languages does Nadia speak?

A French only
B English only
C French and English
D Arabic

1.6 Listening

Tip Listen **once**. Choose. Move on. Never leave a question empty. In the app, tap the speaker; in the book, ask a friend to read the script from the answer key or use the app.

LISTENING 1.6

Short messages

You hear each message once.

1. Where does Karim live?

A Rabat
B Montréal
C Ottawa
D Paris

2. Which languages does the woman speak?

A French and English
B English and Spanish
C Only Spanish
D Arabic and French

3. What is Priya's nationality?

A Chinese
B Indian
C Filipino
D Haitian

4. What is the man's last name?

A Gagnon
B Gannon
C Gaignon
D Gagnan

5. What time of day is it?

A Morning
B Evening
C Noon
D Midnight

1.7 Reading

Nom : Haddad · Prénom : Samira · Nationalité : algérienne · Langues : arabe, français

READING 1.7a

A form

Read the form. Choose the best answer.

1. What is Samira's last name?

A Samira
B Haddad
C Algérie
D Arabe

2. Which languages does Samira speak?

A Arabic and French
B Arabic and English
C French and English
D Only Arabic

Bonjour, je m'appelle Léa. J'habite à Gatineau. Je parle français et un peu anglais.

READING 1.7b

A short message

Read the message. Choose the best answer.

1. What does Léa say about English?

A She speaks it well
B She speaks a little
C She does not speak it
D She teaches it

2. Where does Léa live?

A Ottawa
B Gatineau
C Montréal
D Toronto

1.8 Writing

WRITING 1.8W

Introduce yourself in four sentences

Write four sentences: your name, your nationality, where you live, which languages you speak. Use *Je m'appelle*, *Je suis*, *J'habite à*, *Je parle*.

Check your text:

- Capital letter at the start, full stop at the end.
- Nationality: masculine or feminine for you?
- *J'habite* with an apostrophe.
- *Je parle*, not *je parles*.

WRITING 1.8W2

Fill a form

Fill in this form for yourself: Nom, Prénom, Nationalité, Ville (city), Langues.

Check your text:

- Nationality: write *canadien* for a man, *canadienne* for a woman.

1.9 Speaking

SPEAKING 1.9S

Meet someone

Say a short conversation: greet, say your name, ask their name, say where you live, say what you speak. Record yourself. Use *vous* first.

- Greet first. Smile. Slow and clear is better than fast.
- End with *Et vous ?* to keep the conversation going.

1.10 TCF corner and checkpoint

The first questions of the real TCF Canada listening and reading tests are A1. They are short and clear. Here are exam-style items using only what you know.

LISTENING 1.10L

TCF listening (one play)

You hear each recording once. Four options. Choose one. Never leave it empty.

1. What is the speaker's last name?

A Léa
B Gagnon
C Marc
D Diallo

2. Which language does the speaker speak?

A French
B English
C Spanish
D Arabic

3. Where does the speaker live?

A Toronto
B Montréal
C Ottawa
D Vancouver

4. What is Nadia's nationality?

A Moroccan
B Algerian
C Haitian
D Colombian

READING 1.10R

TCF reading

Read each text. Choose the best answer.

Bonsoir ! Je m'appelle Marc. Je suis canadien. J'habite à Ottawa.

1. Where does Marc live?

A Toronto
B Ottawa
C Montréal
D Paris

Nom : Diallo
Prénom : Awa

2. Which is the first name?

A Diallo
B Awa
C Nom
D Prénom

Je parle français, anglais et espagnol.

3. How many languages?

A Two
B Three
C Four
D One

READING 1.10C

Checkpoint: 10 questions

Choose the best answer. Aim for 8 or more before moving on.

1. Which word means 'last name' on a form?

A prénom
B nom
C pays
D langue

2. Je ___ canadien.

A suis
B es
C est
D êtes

3. Tu ___ Sam ?

A suis
B es
C est
D sommes

4. Which pronoun for a stranger at an office?

A tu
B vous
C il
D elle

5. Elle ___ Nadia.

A m'appelle
B s'appelle
C t'appelles
D vous appelez

6. Elle est ___. (from France)

A français
B française
C francais
D France

7. 'Je parle un peu anglais' means...

A I speak English well
B I speak a little English
C I do not speak English
D I teach English

8. Which greeting in the evening?

A bonjour
B bonsoir
C salut
D allô

9. J'___ à Ottawa.

A habite
B habites
C habitent
D habiter

10. Which one is the feminine of canadien?

A canadienne
B canadiene
C canadiens
D canadian

Unit 1 checklist

- I can greet in the morning and the evening.
- I can say my name, nationality, city and languages.
- I know when to use tu and vous.
- I can use être and the -er verbs for je, tu, il, elle.
- I can say a nationality as a man or as a woman.
- I can spell my name and understand a name on a form.

UNIT 2

2

Greet, be polite, spell your name

AFTER THIS UNIT YOU CAN

Greet at different times of the day, be polite, ask someone to repeat or speak slowly, say my age, spell my name and email, and ask simple questions.

THE SITUATION

At a library desk, on the phone, at a counter: people speak fast, you do not catch everything, and you must give your name and email. This unit gives you the polite words and the questions that keep a conversation alive.

In Canada **Courriel** is the Canadian word for email. **Cellulaire** (or *cell*) is the Canadian word for mobile phone. In France: *mail* and *portable*.

In Canada In Canada **bienvenue** also means *you're welcome* after someone says thank you. In France people say *de rien*. Both are fine.

2.1 Words

Group 1: be polite

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
s'il vous plaît	seel voo PLEH	please (formal)	Votre nom, s'il vous plaît ? Your name, please?
s'il te plaît	seel tuh PLEH	please (friends)	Répète, s'il te plaît. Say it again, please.
merci	mehR-SEE	thank you	Merci, madame. Thank you, madam.
merci beaucoup	mehR-SEE boh-KOO	thank you very much	Merci beaucoup, madame. Thank you very much, madam.
de rien	duh RYA(N)	you're welcome (lit. of nothing)	Merci ! — De rien. Thank you! — You're welcome.
bienvenue	bya(n)-vuh-NÜ	you're welcome (Canada), welcome	Merci. — Bienvenue ! Thank you. — You're welcome!
excusez-moi	ehk-skü-zay-MWAH	excuse me	Excusez-moi, monsieur. Excuse me, sir.
pardon	pahR-DOH(N)	pardon, sorry, excuse me	Pardon ? Sorry? (I did not hear)
désolé / désolée	day-zoh-LAY	sorry	Désolé, je ne comprends pas. Sorry, I do not understand.
d'accord	dah-KOHR	okay, agreed	Oui, d'accord. Yes, okay.

Group 2: when you do not understand

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
comprendre	koh(n)-PRAH(N)dr	to understand	Je comprends un peu. I understand a little.
répéter	ray-pay-TAY	to repeat	Pouvez-vous répéter ? Can you repeat?
lentement	lah(n)t-MAH(N)	slowly	Parlez lentement, s'il vous plaît. Speak slowly, please.
plus	plü	more	Plus lentement, s'il vous plaît. More slowly, please.
encore	ah(n)-KOHR	again, still	Encore une fois. One more time.
aider	eh-DAY	to help	Aidez-moi, s'il vous plaît. Help me, please.
l'aide (f.)	lehd	help	Merci pour l'aide, madame. Thank you for the help, madam.
la question	lah kehs-TYOH(N)	question	J'ai une question. I have a question.
la réponse	lah ray-POH(N)S	answer	La réponse est oui. The answer is yes.
le mot	luh moh	word	Le mot « sortie » est français. The word “sortie” is French.
la phrase	lah frahz	sentence	C'est une phrase. It is a sentence.

In Canada Asking someone to repeat is **normal and respected**. Canadians (and examiners) expect it. *Pardon ?* is the shortest. *Pouvez-vous répéter, s'il vous plaît ?* is the polite full form. *Plus lentement, s'il vous plaît* works every time.

Group 3: age

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
avoir	ah-VWAHR	to have	Avoir trente ans. To be thirty (to have thirty years).
l'âge (m.)	lahzh	age	Quel âge ? How old?
un an / des ans	uh(n) nah(n) / lay zah(n)	year / years	J'ai trente ans. I am thirty (years old).
jeune	zhuhn	young	Elle est jeune. She is young.
quel / quelle	kel	which, what	Quelle langue ? Which language?

Group 4: question words

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
qui	kee	who	Qui est-ce ? Who is it?
que / quoi	kuh / kwah	what	Qu'est-ce que c'est ? What is it?
où	oo	where	Où habitez-vous ? Where do you live?
quand	kah(n)	when	Quand ? Lundi. When? Monday.
comment	koh-MAH(N)	how	Comment ça s'écrit ? How is it spelled?
combien	koh(n)-BYA(N)	how much, how many	C'est combien ? How much is it?
pourquoi	poor-KWAH	why	Pourquoi pas ? Why not?
parce que	pahrs-KUH	because	Parce que je suis canadien. Because I am Canadian.
est-ce que	ehs-kuh	(starts a yes/no question)	Est-ce que vous parlez français ? Do you speak French?

Group 5: email, phone, library

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
le courriel	koo-RYEL	email (Canada)	Votre courriel, s'il vous plaît ? Your email, please?
l'arobase (f.)	lah-roh-BAHZ	the @ sign	L'arobase est dans le courriel. The @ sign is in the email.
le point	luh pwa(n)	dot, full stop	Courriel : sam, arobase, exemple, point c-a. Email: sam, at, example, dot c-a.
le numéro	luh nü-may-ROH	number	Votre numéro, s'il vous plaît ? Your number, please?
le téléphone	luh tay-lay-FOHN	telephone	Le téléphone est là. The phone is there.
le cellulaire	luh sel-ü-LEHR	cell phone (Canada)	Mon numéro de cellulaire. My cell number.
le message	luh meh-SAHZH	message	Un message pour Marc. A message for Marc.
la boîte vocale	lah bwaht voh-KAHL	voicemail	Un message dans la boîte vocale. A message in the voicemail.

appeler	ah-puh-LAY	to call	Appelez-moi, s'il vous plaît. Call me, please.
écrire	ay-KREER	to write	Ça s'écrit D-I-A-L-L-O. It is spelled D-I-A-L-L-O.
la bibliothèque	lah bee-blee-oh-TEK	library	Sam est à la bibliothèque. Sam is at the library.
la carte	lah kahrt	card	La carte est ici. The card is here.

2.2 Phrases

Phrases for real conversations

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
Pardon ?	pahR-DOH(N)	Sorry? (I did not hear)	
Pouvez-vous répéter, s'il vous plaît ?	poo-vay-voo ray-pay-TAY seel voo PLEH	Can you repeat, please?	
Plus lentement, s'il vous plaît.	plü lah(n)t-MAH(N) seel voo PLEH	More slowly, please.	
Je ne comprends pas.	zhuh nuh koh(n)-PRAH(N) pah	I do not understand.	
Je comprends un peu.	zhuh koh(n)-PRAH(N) uh(n) puh	I understand a little.	
Comment ça s'écrit ?	koh-mah(n) sah say-KREE	How is it spelled?	
Comment dit-on « email » en français ?	koh-mah(n) dee-TOH(N)	How do you say “email” in French?	
Quel âge avez-vous ?	kel ahzh ah-vay-VOO	How old are you? (formal)	
J'ai trente ans.	zhay trah(n)-TAH(N)	I am thirty.	
Quel est votre numéro de téléphone ?	kel eh vohtr nü-may-ROH duh tay-lay-FOHN	What is your phone number?	
Mon courriel est…	moh(n) koo-RYEL eh	My email is…	
Pas de problème.	pah duh proh-BLEM	No problem.	
Ça va ?	sah VAH	How are you? (informal)	
Comment allez-vous ?	koh-mah(n) tah-lay-VOO	How are you? (formal)	
Ça va bien, merci.	sah vah BYA(N) mehr-SEE	I am fine, thank you.	
Très bien. / Pas mal.	treh BYA(N) / pah MAHL	Very well. / Not bad.	

SPEAKING 2.2S

Rescue phrases

Say these three out loud until they are automatic: *Pardon ? · Pouvez-vous répéter, s'il vous plaît ? · Plus lentement, s'il vous plaît.* Then say them with a calm, friendly voice, as if you were at a counter.

- Politeness is not weakness: examiners and clerks respond well to a calm *s'il vous plaît*.

2.3 Grammar: how the words connect

A. avoir: to have (g02)

avoir is the second most important verb. It also gives you **age**: in French you *have* years, you are not years.

avoir (to have), present

PERSON	FORM	SAY IT	EXAMPLE
j'	ai	ay	J'ai trente ans.
tu	as	ah	Tu as un courriel ?
il / elle / on	a	ah	Elle a vingt ans.
nous	avons	ah-VOH(N)	Nous avons une question.

vous	avez	ah-VAY	Vous avez une carte ?
ils / elles	ont	oh(n)	Ils ont un cellulaire.

Watch out **Age uses avoir**, never être: *J'ai trente ans* (I have thirty years). Never *Je suis trente ans*. In English you are 30; in French you have 30. Also: **ils ont** (they have) sounds like **ils sont** (they are) apart from the first sound. Listen for the z: *ils ont* is eel-ZOH(N), *ils sont* is eel-SOH(N).

B. Asking questions (g10)

There are three ways to ask a yes/no question. You use the first two. You recognise the third.

Yes/no questions

WAY	EXAMPLE	USE
1. Voice goes up ↗	Vous parlez français ?	Everyday, easiest. Same words as the statement.
2. est-ce que	Est-ce que vous parlez français ?	Clear, polite, works everywhere.
3. Inversion (verb first)	Parlez-vous français ?	Formal and written. Recognise it.

Question words go at the start (or at the end in casual speech): *Où habitez-vous ? Comment vous appelez-vous ? Quel âge avez-vous ? Quand ? Pourquoi ? Combien ?* Answer *pourquoi* with **parce que**.

Questions and answers

QUESTION	ANSWER
Comment vous appelez-vous ?	Je m'appelle Sam.
Où habitez-vous ?	J'habite à Ottawa.
Quel âge avez-vous ?	J'ai trente ans.
Pourquoi vous parlez français ?	Parce que j'habite au Canada.

Tip When you are unsure, add **est-ce que** and keep the rest of the sentence unchanged: *Est-ce que + normal sentence ?* It is never wrong.

In Canada In Québec you will often hear **-tu** added at the end of a question: *Tu viens-tu ?* It is informal Québec speech. Understand it, but in the exam use *est-ce que* or rising intonation.

EXERCISE 2.3A

avoir

Write the right form of *avoir*.

1. J'___ trente ans.
2. Tu ___ un courriel ?
3. Elle ___ vingt ans.
4. Nous ___ une question.
5. Vous ___ une carte ?
6. Ils ___ un cellulaire.

EXERCISE 2.3B

Make it a question

Rewrite each sentence as a question with *est-ce que*.

1. Vous parlez français.
2. Tu habites à Ottawa.
3. Elle comprend.
4. Vous avez un courriel.

EXERCISE 2.3C

Which question word?

Choose: *où, comment, quel, combien, pourquoi.*

1. ___ âge avez-vous ?
2. ___ vous appelez-vous ?
3. ___ habitez-vous ?
4. ___ vous parlez français ? — Parce que j'habite au Canada.

EXERCISE 2.3D

Age

Write the answer to *Quel âge avez-vous ?* with these ages.

1. 25
2. 32
3. 41
4. 60

2.4 Dialogues

On the phone: an email address

Marc calls Sam. They are friends, so they use tu.

Marc Allô, Sam ? C'est Marc.
Hello, Sam? It is Marc.

Sam Salut, Marc ! Ça va ?
Hi, Marc! How are you?

Marc Oui, ça va. Tu as un courriel ?
Yes, fine. Do you have an email?

Sam Oui. Mon courriel est sam, arobase, exemple, point c-a.
Yes. My email is sam, at, example, dot c-a.

Marc Pardon ? Répète, s'il te plaît.
Sorry? Say it again, please.

Sam Oui. Plus lentement. S-A-M, arobase...
Yes. More slowly. S-A-M, at...

Marc D'accord. Merci beaucoup !
Okay. Thank you very much!

Sam Bienvenue !
You're welcome!

At the library desk

Samira gets a library card. The librarian uses vous.

Employée Bonjour, madame. Votre nom, s'il vous plaît ?
Hello, madam. Your name, please?

Samira Haddad. Ça s'écrit H-A-D-D-A-D.
Haddad. It is spelled H-A-D-D-A-D.

Employée Merci. Quel âge avez-vous ?
Thank you. How old are you?

Samira J'ai trente-deux ans.
I am thirty-two.

Employée Et votre numéro de téléphone ?
And your phone number?

Samira Pardon ? Plus lentement, s'il vous plaît.
Sorry? More slowly, please.

Employée Votre numéro de cellulaire, s'il vous plaît.
Your cell phone number, please.

Samira Ah, d'accord ! C'est le six, un, trois, cinq, cinq, cinq, zéro, un, quatre, deux.
Ah, okay! It is 613 555 0142.

READING 2.4

Understand the dialogues

Choose the best answer.

1. Why does Marc ask Sam to repeat?

A He is angry
B He did not catch the email
C He wants a phone number
D He is leaving

2. How old is Samira?

A Twenty-two
B Thirty-two
C Forty-two
D Twenty-three

3. What does the librarian want at the end?

A Her email
B Her cell number
C Her address
D Her age

4. What does Sam say after Marc thanks him?

A Bienvenue
B Pardon
C Désolé
D Salut

2.5 Story

Before you read

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
la dame	lah dahm	lady	La dame parle français. The lady speaks French.
répète	ray-PET	repeats (répéter)	Sam répète lentement. Sam repeats slowly.
écrit	ay-KREE	writes (écrire)	La dame écrit le nom. The lady writes the name.

STORY

À la bibliothèque

At the library

Sam est à la bibliothèque.
Sam is at the library.

Il parle avec une dame.
He is speaking with a lady.

« Bonjour, monsieur. Votre nom, s'il vous plaît ? »
"Hello, sir. Your name, please?"

« Tremblay. T-R-E-M-B-L-A-Y. »
"Tremblay. T-R-E-M-B-L-A-Y."

« Et votre courriel ? »
"And your email?"

Sam dit : « sam, arobase, exemple, point c-a. »
Sam says: "sam, at, example, dot c-a."

« Pardon ? Pouvez-vous répéter, s'il vous plaît ? »
"Sorry? Can you repeat, please?"

Sam répète lentement.
Sam repeats slowly.
Lentement is built from *lent* (slow) + *-ment*, like *-ly* in English.

La dame écrit. « Merci, monsieur. Bienvenue ! »
The lady writes. "Thank you, sir. Welcome!"
Here *bienvenue* means *welcome*: she welcomes him to the library.

READING 2.5

Story questions

Choose the best answer.

1. Where is Sam?

A At a clinic
B At the library
C At the bank
D At school

2. Why does the lady say Pardon?

A She did not hear the email
B She does not like the name
C She is leaving
D She wants a card

3. How does Sam repeat the email?

A Quickly
B Slowly
C Loudly
D In English

2.6 Listening

LISTENING 2.6

Short messages

You hear each recording once.

1. What does the person want?

A To buy something
B To hear it again
C To say goodbye
D To give a name

2. How old is the person?

A 22
B 32
C 42
D 23

3. Which name?

A Diallo
B Dialo
C Diallio
D Dialio

4. What does the man say?

A Thank you
B You're welcome
C Sorry
D Goodbye

5. What are the last two digits?

A 98
B 89
C 18
D 19

2.7 Reading

Nom : Tremblay · Prénom : Sam · Âge : 32 ans · Courriel : sam@exemple.ca · Téléphone : 613 555 0142

READING 2.7a

A library card form

Read the form. Choose the best answer.

1. How old is Sam?

A 23
B 32
C 42
D 52

2. What is the area code?

A 514
B 416
C 613
D 911

3. Which one is the email?

A 613 555 0142
B sam@exemple.ca
C Tremblay
D 32 ans

Pardon, Marc. Je ne comprends pas. Pouvez-vous répéter, s'il vous plaît ? Merci !

READING 2.7b

A short message

Read the message. Choose the best answer.

1. What does the writer say?

A He understands everything
B He does not understand
C He is angry
D He is leaving

2. What does he ask Marc to do?

A Call him
B Repeat
C Come here
D Write an email

2.8 Writing

WRITING 2.8W

Ask someone to repeat

Write a short message to a classmate: say you do not understand, ask them to repeat more slowly, and say thank you.

Check your text:

- Start with a greeting.
- *Je ne comprends pas.*
- *Plus lentement, s'il vous plaît.*
- End with *Merci.*

WRITING 2.8W2

Fill a library form

Fill in this form for yourself: Nom, Prénom, Âge, Courriel, Téléphone.

Check your text:

- Use *ans* after the age.
- Write the email with @ and a dot.

2.9 Speaking

SPEAKING 2.9S

At the desk

Say a short conversation: give your name, spell it, say your age, give your email and phone number. Use *vous* with the clerk and *Pardon ? Plus lentement* when you need it. Record yourself.

- Say the digits in short groups, with a short pause.
- If you make a mistake, say *Pardon* and repeat. It is normal.

2.10 TCF corner and checkpoint

LISTENING 2.10L

TCF listening (one play)

You hear each recording once. Four options.

1. Which city has this area code (416)?

A Toronto
B Montréal
C Ottawa
D Québec

2. How old is the person?

A 20
B 21
C 12
D 31

3. What does the person ask?

A To speak more slowly
B To speak louder
C To leave
D To write

4. What does the email end with?

A .com
B .ca
C .fr
D .org

READING 2.10R

TCF reading

Read. Choose the best answer.

Bonsoir ! Je m'appelle Karim. J'ai vingt-huit ans. Je parle arabe et français.

1. How old is Karim?

A 18
B 28
C 38
D 82

Merci beaucoup ! — Bienvenue !

2. What does the second person say?

A Thank you
B You're welcome
C Sorry
D Hello

Votre numéro de cellulaire, s'il vous plaît ?

3. What does the person want?

A An address
B A cell phone number
C A name
D An age

READING 2.10C

Checkpoint: 10 questions

Aim for 8 or more before moving on.

1. Which is the polite way to ask for repetition?

A Quoi ?
B Pouvez-vous répéter, s'il vous plaît ?
C Répète !
D Non.

2. J'___ trente ans.

A suis
B ai
C as
D a

3. Elle ___ vingt ans.

A est
B ai
C a
D ont

4. Which question word means 'where'?

A où
B quand
C comment
D pourquoi

5. Which question word means 'how'?

A où
B quand
C comment
D combien

6. Which way is formal?

A Vous parlez français ?
B Parlez-vous français ?
C Tu parles français ?
D Parle français ?

7. 'Je ne comprends pas' means...

A I understand
B I do not understand
C I speak
D I repeat

8. Which word is Canadian for 'email'?

A mail
B courriel
C message
D lettre

9. How do you answer 'Merci' in Canada?

A Bienvenue
B Bonsoir
C Salut
D Pardon

10. 'Ça s'écrit comment ?' asks for...

A the age
B the spelling
C the address
D the price

Unit 2 checklist

- I can be polite and say thank you in two ways.
- I can ask someone to repeat and to speak slowly.

- I can say my age with avoir.
- I can ask yes/no questions in two ways.
- I can use où, comment, quel, quand, pourquoi.
- I can spell my name and email and say my phone number.

UNIT 3

3

Forms and papers

AFTER THIS UNIT YOU CAN

Understand and fill in the basic personal details on a form, name my main documents, say my address, postal code and date of birth aloud, and use le, la, les, un, une and des correctly.

THE SITUATION

Service Canada, a bank, a clinic, a landlord: every new life in Canada starts with a form. Forms are the most predictable French you will ever meet. Learn the fields once and you can read most of them.

In Canada Official forms in Canada are in French and English. The French side uses the same short labels again and again: **Nom, Prénom, Adresse, Code postal, Date de naissance**.

In Canada Your **NAS** (numéro d'assurance sociale) is the Social Insurance Number, SIN in English. You will be asked for it at work, at the bank and for taxes.

3.1 Words

Group 1: on the form

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
le formulaire	luh fohr-mü-LEHR	form	Voici le formulaire. Here is the form.
remplir	rah(n)-PLEER	to fill in	Remplissez le formulaire. Fill in the form.
signer	see-NYAY	to sign	Signez ici, s'il vous plaît. Sign here, please.
la signature	lah see-nyah-TÜR	signature	Votre signature, s'il vous plaît. Your signature, please.
l'adresse (f.)	lah-DREHS	address	Votre adresse, s'il vous plaît ? Your address, please?
la rue	lah Rü	street	J'habite rue Sainte-Catherine. I live on Sainte-Catherine Street.
le code postal	luh kohd poh-STAHL	postal code	Mon code postal est H3B 1A7. My postal code is H3B 1A7.
l'appartement (m.)	lah-pahr-tuh-MAH(N)	apartment (written app.)	Appartement douze (app. 12). Apartment twelve.
la date de naissance	lah daht duh neh-SAH(N)S	date of birth	Votre date de naissance, s'il vous plaît ? Your date of birth, please?
né / née	nay	born (m. / f.)	Je suis né en 1990. I was born in 1990.

Group 2: documents

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
la pièce d'identité	lah pyes dee-dah(n)-tee-TAY	piece of ID	Votre pièce d'identité, s'il vous plaît. Your ID, please.
le passeport	luh pahs-POHR	passport	Voici mon passeport. Here is my passport.
le permis de conduire	luh pehR-MEE duh koh(n)-DWEER	driver's licence	Voici mon permis de conduire. Here is my driver's licence.
la carte d'assurance maladie	lah kahrt dah-sü-RAH(N)S mah-lah-DEE	health insurance card	Voici ma carte d'assurance maladie. Here is my health insurance card.
le NAS	luh nahs	SIN (Social Insurance Number)	Mon NAS, c'est le... My SIN is...
le permis de travail	luh pehR-MEE duh trah-VAHY	work permit	Voici mon permis de travail. Here is my work permit.
le permis d'études	luh pehR-MEE day-TÜD	study permit	Voici mon permis d'études. Here is my study permit.
la carte de résident permanent	lah kahrt duh ray-zee-DAH(N) pehR-mah-NAH(N)	permanent resident card	Voici ma carte de résident permanent. Here is my permanent resident card.
le certificat de naissance	luh sehR-tee-fee-KAH duh neh-SAH(N)S	birth certificate	Voici mon certificat de naissance. Here is my birth certificate.
le document	luh doh-kü-MAH(N)	document	Les documents sont ici. The documents are here.
accepté / acceptée	ahk-sehp-TAY	accepted (m. / f.)	Les documents acceptés sont ici. Les photocopies ne sont pas acceptées. The accepted documents are here. Photocopies are not accepted.

la photocopie	lah foh-toh-koh-PEE	photocopy	Une photocopie, s'il vous plaît. A photocopy, please.

In Canada **NAS** is said as one word: *nahs*. On a form it is written **NAS** (French) or **SIN** (English). **PR card** is *carte de résident permanent*. These four documents come up again and again: **passeport, permis de travail ou d'études, carte de résident permanent, carte d'assurance maladie**.

Group 3: provinces and small words

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
la province	lah proh-VA(N)S	province	Ontario est une province. Ontario is a province.
la capitale	lah kah-pee-TAHL	capital	Ottawa est la capitale. Ottawa is the capital.
l'Ontario (m.)	lohn-tah-ree-OH	Ontario	J'habite en Ontario. I live in Ontario.
l'Alberta (f.)	lahl-behr-TAH	Alberta	Elle habite en Alberta. She lives in Alberta.
le Manitoba	luh mah-nee-toh-BAH	Manitoba	Il habite au Manitoba. He lives in Manitoba.
la Colombie-Britannique	lah koh-loh(n)-bee bree-tah-NEEK	British Columbia	Je suis en Colombie-Britannique. I am in British Columbia.
le Nouveau-Brunswick	luh noo-VOH bruhnz-WEEK	New Brunswick	Moncton est au Nouveau-Brunswick. Moncton is in New Brunswick.
la Nouvelle-Écosse	lah noo-VEL ay-KOHS	Nova Scotia	Halifax est en Nouvelle-Écosse. Halifax is in Nova Scotia.
ici	ee-SEE	here	Signez ici. Sign here.
voici / voilà	vwah-SEE / vwah-LAH	here is / there is	Voici mon passeport. Here is my passport.

The ten provinces. The country's capital is Ottawa (Ontario).

ENGLISH	FRANÇAIS	CAPITAL
Ontario	l'Ontario	Toronto
Québec	le Québec	Québec
British Columbia	la Colombie-Britannique	Victoria
Alberta	l'Alberta	Edmonton
Manitoba	le Manitoba	Winnipeg
Saskatchewan	la Saskatchewan	Regina
Nova Scotia	la Nouvelle-Écosse	Halifax
New Brunswick	le Nouveau-Brunswick	Fredericton
Prince Edward Island	l'Île-du-Prince-Édouard	Charlottetown
Newfoundland and Labrador	Terre-Neuve-et-Labrador	St. John's

Group 4: small words that organise a conversation

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
d'abord	dah-BOHR	first, at first	D'abord, le nom. First, the name.
ensuite	ah(n)-SWEET	then, next	D'abord le nom, ensuite l'adresse. First the name, then the address.
puis	pwee	then	Le nom, puis l'adresse. The name, then the address.
donner	doh-NAY	to give	Elle donne le formulaire. She gives the form.

parfait	pahR-FEH	perfect	C'est parfait. That is perfect.
principal / principale	pra(n)-see-PAHL	main	la rue Principale Main Street
un, une, des	uh(n), ün, day	a, an, some	Un passeport, une rue, des documents. A passport, a street, some documents.
le, la, l', les	luh, lah, l, lay	the	Le passeport, la rue, l'adresse, les documents. The passport, the street, the address, the documents.

3.2 Phrases

At the counter

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN SI
Votre pièce d'identité, s'il vous plaît.	vohtr pyes dee-dah(n)-tee-TAY seel voo PLEH	Your ID, please.	
Remplissez ce formulaire.	rah(n)-plee-SAY suh fohr-mü-LEHR	Fill in this form.	
Signez ici.	see-NYAY ee-SEE	Sign here.	
Voici mon passeport.	vwah-SEE moh(n) pahs-POHR	Here is my passport.	
Je suis né le quinze avril mille neuf cent quatre-vingt-dix.	zhuh swee nay luh ka(n)z ah-VREEL meel nuhf sah(n) kah-truh-va(n)-DEES	I was born on April 15, 1990.	
J'habite au douze, rue Sainte-Catherine, appartement quatre.	zhah-BEET oh dooz Rü sa(n)t kah-tuh-REEN ah-pahr-tuh-MAH(N) KAHtr	I live at 12 Sainte-Catherine Street, apartment 4.	
Mon code postal est H3B 1A7.	moh(n) kohd poh-STAHL eh ahsh trwah bay uh(n) ah set	My postal code is H3B 1A7.	
C'est parfait. Merci !	seh pahR-FEH mehR-SEE	That is perfect. Thank you!	

In Canada In a Canadian address, the **number comes first**, then the street: *12, rue Sainte-Catherine.* A postal code has letters and numbers: **H3B 1A7**. You say each character: *ahsh, trois, bay, un, ah, sept.* Dates on forms are often written **2026-10-12** (year, month, day). You can say *le douze octobre deux mille vingt-six.*

The months (recognition now, you master them in Unit 6)

Les mois

MONTH	SAY IT	MONTH	SAY IT
janvier	zhah(n)-VYAY	juillet	zhwee-YEH
février	fay-vree-AY	août	oot
mars	mahrs	septembre	sehp-TAH(N)br
avril	ah-VREEL	octobre	ohk-TOHbr
mai	may	novembre	noh-VAH(N)br
juin	zhwa(n)	décembre	day-SAH(N)br

Tip Months are **not** capitalised in French: *le douze octobre*. The day comes **before** the month: *le 12 octobre*, not October 12. The first of the month is *le 1er* (*le premier*).

3.3 Grammar: how the words connect

A. Gender: every noun is masculine or feminine (g05)

All French nouns have a gender, even objects. There is no logic to learn from the meaning, so **always learn a noun with its article**: not *passeport*, but **le passeport**.

Articles

	MASCULINE	FEMININE
the (before a consonant)	le passeport	la signature
the (before a vowel or silent h)	l'appartement (m.)	l'adresse (f.)
a / an	un formulaire	une rue
the (plural)	les passeports	les adresses
some (plural)	des formulaires	des rues

Helpful endings (not perfect rules, but they work most of the time):

Endings that help

USUALLY FEMININE	USUALLY MASCULINE
-tion: la signature, la nation, la station	-ment: le document, l'appartement, le paiement
-té: la nationalité, l'identité, la ville… (many)	-age: le courrier? no: le message, le passage
-ure: la signature, la voiture	-eau: le bureau, le chapeau
-ette, -ine: la cigarette, la cuisine	most words ending in a consonant: le passeport, le nom

Watch out **la ville** (city) and **la maison** (house) are feminine; **le pays** (country) and **le nom** (name) are masculine. **Do not guess from English.** When you learn a new noun, say it with its article three times.

Tip In a dictionary or list you see **n.m.** (masculine noun) or **n.f.** (feminine noun). In this book we write **(m.)** and **(f.)** when the article does not show it (*l'adresse (f.)*).

B. More than one: the plural (g06)

To make a plural, **add -s** to the noun and change the article: *le passeport → les passeports*, *une rue → des rues*. The **s is silent**, so you hear the plural only in the **article**: *le → les* (lay), *un/une → des* (day).

Plural nouns

SINGULAR	PLURAL	SAY IT
le formulaire	les formulaires	lay fohr-mü-LEHR
la rue	les rues	lay Rü
une adresse	des adresses	day zah-DREHS (liaison)
l'appartement	les appartements	lay zah-pahr-tuh-MAH(N)
le document	les documents	lay doh-kü-MAH(N)

- **-eau → -eaux**: *le bureau → les bureaux*.
- **-al → -aux**: *le journal → les journaux*.
- Words already ending in **-s, -x, -z** do not change: *le pays → les pays*.
- Before a vowel, **les / des** link with a **z**: *les adresses* (lay-zah-DREHS).

In Canada On forms and in official French you see the **masculine** as the default. Canadian offices increasingly write both: *Né(e) le*, *Canadien(ne)*. The (e) tells you to add an **e** if you are a woman.

C. votre / vos: your (formal)

Forms and clerks use **votre** (singular) and **vos** (plural): *votre nom*, *votre adresse*, *vos documents*. For friends you will learn **ton / ta / tes** in Unit 4.

EXERCISE 3.3A

le, la, l' or les?

Write the right word for *the*.

1. ___ formulaire
2. ___ adresse
3. ___ signature
4. ___ passeports
5. ___ appartement
6. ___ rue

EXERCISE 3.3B

un, une or des?

Write the right word for *a / some*.

1. ___ code postal
2. ___ province
3. ___ documents
4. ___ pièce d'identité
5. ___ permis de travail
6. ___ cartes

EXERCISE 3.3C

Make it plural

Write the plural with the article *les*.

1. le formulaire
2. la rue
3. l'adresse
4. le pays
5. le bureau

EXERCISE 3.3D

Say the postal code

Write each postal code in French sounds (letters and digits).

1. H3B 1A7
2. K1A 0B1
3. M5V 2T6

3.4 Dialogues

At Service Canada: the SIN

Priya wants a SIN. The agent uses vous.

L'agent Bonjour, madame. Votre pièce d'identité, s'il vous plaît ?
Hello, madam. Your ID, please?

Priya Voici mon passeport et mon permis de travail.
Here is my passport and my work permit.

L'agent Merci. Votre nom et votre prénom ?
Thank you. Your last name and first name?

Priya Patel. Priya. P-A-T-E-L.
Patel. Priya. P-A-T-E-L.

L'agent Votre date de naissance ?
Your date of birth?

Priya Je suis née le quinze avril mille neuf cent quatre-vingt-dix.
I was born on April 15, 1990.

L'agent Votre adresse ?
Your address?

Priya J'habite au douze, rue Sainte-Catherine, appartement quatre, Montréal.
I live at 12 Sainte-Catherine Street, apartment 4, Montréal.

L'agent Et le code postal ?
And the postal code?

Priya C'est H3B 1A7.
It is H3B 1A7.

L'agent Parfait. Signez ici, s'il vous plaît.
Perfect. Sign here, please.

READING 3.4

Understand the dialogue

Choose the best answer.

1. Which documents does Priya show?

A Passport and work permit
B Passport and health card
C Licence and PR card
D Birth certificate only

2. When was Priya born?

A April 15, 1990
B April 5, 1990
C May 15, 1990
D April 15, 1999

3. What is the apartment number?

A 2
B 4
C 12
D 14

4. What does the agent ask at the end?

A To sign
B To wait
C To pay
D To call

3.5 Story

Before you read

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
l'agent (m.)	lah-ZHAH(N)	agent, officer	L'agent donne un formulaire. The agent gives a form.
il / elle remplit	eel / el rah(n)-PLEE	fills in (remplir)	Elle remplit le formulaire. She fills in the form.
il / elle signe	eel / el SEE-nyuh	signs (signer)	Il signe ici. He signs here.

STORY

Le formulaire

The form

Priya est à Service Canada.
Priya is at Service Canada.
Service Canada is the federal office for the SIN, benefits and many documents.

L'agent donne un formulaire.
The agent gives her a form.

Elle remplit le formulaire.
She fills in the form.

D'abord, le nom et le prénom.
First, the last name and the first name.

Ensuite, l'adresse et le code postal.
Then, the address and the postal code.
In an address, French writes the number first and the street name after.

Le code postal est H3B 1A7.
The postal code is H3B 1A7.

Puis elle signe le formulaire.
Then she signs the form.

L'agent dit : « C'est parfait, madame. Merci ! »
The agent says: "That is perfect, madam. Thank you!"

READING 3.5

Story questions

Choose the best answer.

1. What does the agent give Priya?

A A card
B A form
C A passport
D A phone

2. What does she write first?

A The postal code
B The name
C The signature
D The age

3. What does she do last?

A Pays
B Signs the form
C Calls
D Leaves

3.6 Listening

LISTENING 3.6

At the counter

You hear each recording once.

1. Which postal code?

A H3B 1A7
B H3B 1A9
C H3D 1A7
D K3B 1A7

2. What month?

A March
B April
C August
D October

3. What is the apartment number?

A 3
B 6
C 16
D 23

4. Which document is shown?

A A passport
B A licence
C A health card
D A work permit

5. What must the person do?

A Pay
B Sign
C Wait
D Call

3.7 Reading

Nom : Patel · Prénom : Priya · Date de naissance : 1990-04-15 · Adresse : 12, rue Sainte-Catherine, app. 4 · Ville : Montréal · Province : Québec · Code postal : H3B 1A7

READING 3.7a

A form

Read the form. Choose the best answer.

1. What is the province?

A Ontario
B Québec
C Alberta
D Manitoba

2. What is the first name?

A Patel
B Priya
C Montréal
D Sainte-Catherine

3. Which year was she born?

A 1900
B 1990
C 1999
D 2010

Documents acceptés : passeport, permis de travail, carte de résident permanent. Les photocopies ne sont pas acceptées.

READING 3.7b

A sign

Read the sign. Choose the best answer.

1. Which document is accepted?

A A photocopy
B A passport
C A phone photo
D A library card

2. Which is NOT accepted?

A Work permit
B Passport
C Photocopies
D PR card

3.8 Writing

WRITING 3.8W

Fill in the form

Fill in this form for yourself: Nom, Prénom, Date de naissance (year-month-day), Adresse, Ville, Province, Code postal.

Check your text:

- Date: year-month-day, with hyphens.
- Address: number first, then the street.
- Postal code: letter, digit, letter, space, digit, letter, digit.

WRITING 3.8W2

Write your address in a sentence

Write one sentence that gives your address and postal code. Use *J'habite au…* and *Mon code postal est…*

Check your text:

- Say the number in letters when you write a full sentence.

3.9 Speaking

SPEAKING 3.9S

At the counter

Say a short conversation with an agent: show an ID, give your name, date of birth, address and postal code. Use *vous* and *Voici…* Record yourself.

- Say the postal code slowly, character by character.
- End with *Merci, madame.*

3.10 TCF corner and checkpoint

LISTENING 3.10L

TCF listening (one play)

You hear each recording once.

1. What is the street number?

A 14 **B** 24
C 42 **D** 52

2. Which city has this area code (613)?

A Toronto **B** Montréal
C Ottawa **D** Vancouver

3. Which date?

A May 3, 2000 **B** March 5, 2000
C May 13, 2000 **D** May 3, 2010

4. What does the agent give?

A A card **B** A form
C A passport **D** A key

READING 3.10R

TCF reading

Read. Choose the best answer.

Pour le NAS : passeport et permis de travail ou d'études.

1. What do you need for the SIN?

A Passport and a permit **B** Only a phone
C A library card **D** A photo

Adresse : 15, rue Principale, Moncton, Nouveau-Brunswick

2. Which province?

A Québec **B** Manitoba
C New Brunswick **D** Nova Scotia

Nom : Diallo · Prénom : Awa · Né(e) le : 2001-09-30

3. Which month was she born?

A August **B** September
C November **D** March

READING 3.10C

Checkpoint: 10 questions

Aim for 8 or more before moving on.

1. ___ adresse (the address)

A le **B** la
C l' **D** les

2. ___ formulaire (a form)

A un **B** une
C des **D** les

3. Plural of 'la rue'?

A les rues
B les rue
C le rues
D des rue

4. Plural of 'le pays'?

A les pays
B les païs
C le pays
D les payss

5. What does 'né le' mean?

A born on
B named
C lives
D wants

6. In a Canadian address, what comes first?

A The street name
B The number
C The city
D The province

7. Which one is a province?

A Ottawa
B Ontario
C Montréal
D Gatineau

8. 'NAS' in English is...

A SIN
B PR
C ID
D GST

9. Which word is formal for 'your'?

A votre
B ton
C ta
D tes

10. 'Signez ici' means...

A Sign here
B Come here
C Pay here
D Wait here

Unit 3 checklist

- I can read the usual fields on a form and fill them in.
- I can name my main documents (passeport, permis, carte, NAS).
- I can say my address, postal code and date of birth.
- I know every noun has a gender, and I learn it with le or la.
- I can use un, une, des, le, la, l', les.
- I can make most nouns plural and I know the s is silent.

UNIT 4

4

Family and people

AFTER THIS UNIT YOU CAN

Name my family members, say whose something is, describe a person simply (age, looks, colours), and talk about what several people do.

THE SITUATION

A photo on your phone, a school registration, an immigration form that asks about your spouse and children, a neighbour who asks who is in your family. Family is the most natural topic for a first real conversation.

In Canada Canadian forms ask for your **situation familiale** (marital status): *célibataire* (single), *marié(e)*, *conjoint(e) de fait* (common-law partner), *divorcé(e)*, *veuf / veuve* (widowed). **Conjoint(e)** means spouse or partner and is the word used on immigration forms.

In Canada In Canada people often say **ma blonde** or **mon chum** for girlfriend or boyfriend. That is informal Québec French. Learn it to understand it. On forms and in the exam, use **conjoint(e)**, **mari**, **femme**.

4.1 Words

Group 1: family

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
la famille	lah fah-MEEY	family	Voici ma famille. Here is my family.
le père	luh pehR	father	Mon père est canadien. My father is Canadian.
la mère	lah mehR	mother	Ma mère s'appelle Nadia. My mother is called Nadia.
les parents	lay pah-RAH(N)	parents (also: relatives)	Mes parents habitent à Ottawa. My parents live in Ottawa.
le frère	luh frehR	brother	Mon frère est grand. My brother is tall.
la sœur	lah suhR	sister	Ma sœur a vingt ans. My sister is twenty.
le fils	luh fees	son (the s is said!)	Mon fils s'appelle Omar. My son is called Omar.
la fille	lah feey	daughter, girl	Ma fille a cinq ans. My daughter is five.
le mari	luh mah-REE	husband	Mon mari travaille à l'hôpital. My husband works at the hospital.
la femme	lah fahm	wife, woman	Voici ma femme. Here is my wife.
le conjoint / la conjointe	luh koh(n)-ZHWA(N) / lah koh(n)-ZHWA(N)T	spouse, partner	Nom du conjoint : Haddad. Name of spouse: Haddad.
le grand-père / la grand-mère	luh grah(n)-PEHR / lah grah(n)-MEHR	grandfather / grandmother	Ma grand-mère habite à Gatineau. My grandmother lives in Gatineau.
l'oncle / la tante	lohn-kl / lah tah(n)t	uncle / aunt	Mon oncle et ma tante sont à Ottawa. My uncle and aunt are in Ottawa.
le cousin / la cousine	luh koo-ZA(N) / lah koo-ZEEN	cousin (m. / f.)	Ma cousine est étudiante. My cousin is a student.
le bébé	luh bay-BAY	baby	Le bébé est petit. The baby is small.

Watch out **fils** (son) is said **fees**, with the s. It is one of the few exceptions to the silent-final-s rule. **fille** is **feey**, not "fill". Do not mix **fils** (son) with **fil** (thread).

Group 2: describe a person

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
grand / grande	grah(n) / grah(n)d	tall, big	Mon frère est grand. My brother is tall.
petit / petite	puh-TEE / puh-TEET	small, short	Elle est petite. She is small.
jeune	zhuhn	young	Mon frère est jeune. My brother is young.
vieux / vieille	vyuh / vyeey	old (not for people politely: say âgé)	L'immeuble est vieux. The building is old.
beau / belle	boh / bel	handsome, beautiful	Ma mère est belle. My mother is beautiful.
gentil / gentille	zhah(n)-TEE / zhah(n)-TEEY	kind, nice	Ma tante est gentille. My aunt is kind.

sympathique	sa(n)-pah-TEEK	friendly, nice (informal: sympa)	Ma tante est sympathique. My aunt is friendly.
content / contente	koh(n)-TAH(N) / koh(n)-TAH(N)T	happy	Je suis content. I am happy.
fatigué / fatiguée	fah-tee-GAY	tired	Je suis fatigué. I am tired.
marié / mariée	mah-RYAY	married	Je suis marié. I am married.
célibataire	say-lee-bah-TEHR	single (not married)	Il est célibataire. He is single.

Group 3: hair, eyes and colours

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
les cheveux (m.)	lay shuh-VUH	hair	Elle a les cheveux bruns. She has brown hair.
les yeux (m.)	lay zyuh	eyes	Elle a les yeux bleus. She has blue eyes.
blond / blonde	bloh(n) / bloh(n)d	blond	Léa est blonde. Léa is blond.
brun / brune	bruh(n) / brün	dark brown	Ma sœur est brune. My sister has dark brown hair.
roux / rousse	roo / roos	red-haired	Il a les cheveux roux. He has red hair.
rouge	roozh	red	La valise est rouge. The suitcase is red.
bleu / bleue	bluh	blue	Le téléphone est bleu. The phone is blue.
vert / verte	vehr / vehrt	green	Le formulaire est vert. The form is green.
jaune	zhohn	yellow	Le couloir est jaune. The hallway is yellow.
noir / noire	nwahr	black	La valise est noire. The suitcase is black.
blanc / blanche	blah(n) / blah(n)sh	white	L'immeuble est blanc. The building is white.
gris / grise	gree / greez	grey	Le téléphone est gris. The phone is grey.
rose	rohz	pink	La carte est rose. The card is pink.
orange	oh-RAH(N)zh	orange (never changes)	La valise est orange. The suitcase is orange.
marron	mah-ROH(N)	brown (never changes)	La carte est marron. The card is brown.

Group 4: what people do

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
travailler	trah-vah-YAY	to work	Mon père travaille à l'hôpital. My father works at the hospital.
étudier	ay-tü-DYAY	to study	Ma sœur étudie. My sister studies.
l'étudiant / l'étudiante	lay-tü-DYAH(N) / lay-tü-DYAH(N)T	student (m. / f.)	Ils sont étudiants. They are students.

aussi	oh-SEE	also, too	Moi aussi, je parle français. Me too, I speak French.
beaucoup	boh-KOO	a lot, many	Merci beaucoup. Thank you very much.
tous / toutes	toos / toot	all, everyone	Ils sont tous contents. They are all happy.
le professeur / la professeure	luh proh-feh-SUHR / lah proh-feh-SUHR	teacher (Canada: la professeure)	La professeure parle français. The teacher speaks French.

On a form

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
la situation familiale	lah see-tü-ah-syoh(n) fah-mee-LYAL	marital status (form)	Situation familiale : marié. Marital status: married.
divorcé / divorcée	dee-vohr-SAY	divorced	Il est divorcé. He is divorced.
veuf / veuve	vuhf / vuhv	widowed	Elle est veuve. She is a widow.
conjoint de fait	koh(n)-ZHWA(N) duh feh	common-law partner	Marc et Léa sont conjoints de fait. Marc and Léa are common-law partners.
le nombre	luh NOH(N)br	number, quantity	Nombre d'enfants : 2. Number of children: 2.

4.2 Phrases

Talk about people

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
Voici ma famille.	vwah-SEE mah fah-MEEY	Here is my family.	
J'ai deux enfants.	zhay duh zah(n)-FAH(N)	I have two children.	
Je suis marié. / Je suis mariée.	zhuh swee mah-RYAY	I am married.	
Je suis célibataire.	zhuh swee say-lee-bah-TEHR	I am single.	
Mon fils a cinq ans.	moh(n) fees ah sa(n)k ah(n)	My son is five.	
Elle a les cheveux bruns.	el ah lay shuh-VUH brüh(n)	She has brown hair.	
Il est grand et blond.	eel eh grah(n) ay bloh(n)	He is tall and blond.	
Ma femme travaille à l'hôpital.	mah fahm trah-vahy ah loh-pee-TAHL	My wife works at the hospital.	
Nous habitons à Ottawa.	noo zah-bee-TOH(N) ah oh-tah-WAH	We live in Ottawa.	
Ils parlent français et anglais.	eel pahrl frah(n)-SEH ay ah(n)-GLEH	They speak French and English.	

4.3 Grammar: how the words connect

A. mon, ma, mes: possessives (g11)

Possessives agree with the **thing owned**, not with the owner. *son père* means **his** father or **her** father: only the context tells you.

Possessives

OWNER	MASC. SG.	FEM. SG.	PLURAL
my	mon	ma	mes
your (tu)	ton	ta	tes
his / her	son	sa	ses
our	notre	notre	nos
your (vous)	votre	votre	vos

their	leur	leur	leurs

Possessives in use

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
mon père	moh(n) pehR	my father	Mon père s'appelle Ali. My father is called Ali.
ma mère	mah mehR	my mother	Ma mère travaille. My mother works.
mes parents	may pah-RAH(N)	my parents	Mes parents parlent anglais. My parents speak English.
mon amie	moh(n)-nah-MEE	my friend (f.)	Mon amie est canadienne. My friend is Canadian.
son frère	soh(n) frehR	his / her brother	Son frère est étudiant. His brother is a student.
sa sœur	sah suhR	his / her sister	Sa sœur habite à Toronto. Her sister lives in Toronto.
notre famille	nohtr fah-MEEY	our family	Notre famille est grande. Our family is big.
leurs enfants	luhr zah(n)-FAH(N)	their children	Leurs enfants sont petits. Their children are small.

Watch out Before a feminine word that starts with a vowel, use **mon / ton / son**: *mon amie* (not *ma amie*), *mon adresse*, *son école*. This avoids two vowels meeting.

B. Adjectives agree with the noun (g12)

Adjectives match the **gender and number** of the noun. Add **-e** for feminine, **-s** for plural.

Regular agreement

	MASCULINE	FEMININE	SAY IT
singular	il est grand	elle est grande	grah(n) / grah(n)d
singular	il est petit	elle est petite	puh-TEE / puh-TEET
singular	il est content	elle est contente	koh(n)-TAH(N) / koh(n)-TAH(N)T
plural	ils sont grands	elles sont grandes	same as singular

The same -s rule: the s is silent

PLURAL ADJECTIVES	EXAMPLE
jeunes	Mes parents sont jeunes.
contents	Ils sont contents.
blonds / blondes	Ils ont les cheveux blonds.
verts / vertes	Elle a les yeux verts.
noirs / noires	Il a les cheveux noirs.
filles (plural of fille)	J'ai deux filles.

Some adjectives change more: **beau → belle**, **vieux → vieille**, **gentil → gentille**, **blanc → blanche**, **roux → rousse**. **-e** adjectives do not change in the feminine: *jeune, rouge, célibataire, sympathique*. Colour words used as nouns for things never change: *orange, marron*.

Position. Most adjectives come **after** the noun: *une femme canadienne, un sac noir*. A few short, common ones come **before**: **grand, petit, jeune, vieux, beau, bon, mauvais, nouveau**: *une grande famille, un petit garçon, une belle ville*.

In Canada On Canadian forms: **Né(e)**, **Canadien(ne)**, **Marié(e)**. The (e) tells you to add an e if you are a woman. You choose your form, you do not write both.

C. Verbs with nous, vous, ils, elles (g09b)

-er verbs, present, all persons

PARLER	HABITER	TRAVAILLER

je	parle	j'habite	travaille
tu	parles	habites	travailles
il / elle	parle	habite	travaille
nous	parlons (pahr-LOH(N))	habitons (ah-bee-TOH(N))	travaillons (trah-vah-YOH(N))
vous	parlez (pahr-LAY)	habitez (ah-bee-TAY)	travaillez (trah-vah-YAY)
ils / elles	parlent (pahrl)	habitent (ah-BEET)	travaillent (trah-VAHY)

Watch out **-ent** (ils/elles) is **silent**: *ils parlent* sounds like *il parle*. Listen for the link: *ils habitent* is **eel-zah-BEET**, with a z, while *il habite* is **ee-lah-BEET**. Also note **-ons** (nous) and **-ez** (vous) are always said.

EXERCISE 4.3A

mon, ma or mes?

Write the right word.

1. ___ père
2. ___ mère
3. ___ parents
4. ___ amie (f.)
5. ___ sœur
6. ___ enfants

EXERCISE 4.3B

Make it agree

Write the adjective in the right form.

1. Ma mère est (grand) ___.
2. Mon père est (content) ___.
3. Ma sœur est (petit) ___.
4. Mes enfants sont (jeune) ___.
5. Elle est (beau) ___.
6. Ils sont (marié) ___.

EXERCISE 4.3C

Conjugate

Write the right form.

1. Nous (parler) ___ français.
2. Vous (habiter) ___ à Ottawa ?
3. Ils (travailler) ___ à l'hôpital.
4. Elles (étudier) ___ le français.
5. Nous (travailler) ___ beaucoup.

EXERCISE 4.3D

son, sa or ses?

Write the right word for *his / her*.

1. Marc habite avec ___ père. (père: masc.)
2. Léa habite avec ___ mère. (mère: fem.)
3. Karim parle avec ___ parents.
4. Nadia aime ___ amie. (amie: fem. before a vowel sound: ami(e))

4.4 Dialogues

A photo of the family

Anna and Sam are classmates. Sam shows a photo on his phone.

Anna C'est ta famille ?
Is that your family?

Sam Oui. Voici mon père et ma mère.
Yes. Here are my father and my mother.

Anna Ils sont jeunes !
They are young!

Sam Mon père a soixante ans. Ma mère a cinquante-huit ans.
My father is sixty. My mother is fifty-eight.

Anna Et ça, c'est qui ?
And who is that?

Sam C'est ma sœur. Elle s'appelle Léa. Elle est étudiante.
That is my sister. She is called Léa. She is a student.

Anna Elle est belle. Elle a les cheveux blonds ?
She is pretty. Does she have blond hair?

Sam Non, elle a les cheveux bruns et les yeux verts.
No, she has brown hair and green eyes.

On a form: situation familiale

A clerk helps Karim fill in a form. The clerk uses vous.

L'agente Vous êtes marié, monsieur ?
Are you married, sir?

Karim Oui, je suis marié. Voici ma femme.
Yes, I am married. Here is my wife.

L'agente Comment s'appelle votre conjointe ?
What is your spouse's name?

Karim Elle s'appelle Samira.
She is called Samira.

L'agente Vous avez des enfants ?
Do you have children?

Karim Oui, nous avons deux enfants. Un fils et une fille.
Yes, we have two children. A son and a daughter.

L'agente Ils ont quel âge ?
How old are they?

Karim Mon fils a huit ans et ma fille a cinq ans.
My son is eight and my daughter is five.

READING 4.4

Understand the dialogues

Choose the best answer.

1. How old is Sam's father?

A 50 **B** 58
C 60 **D** 68

2. What colour are Léa's eyes?

A Blue **B** Green
C Brown **D** Grey

3. How many children do Karim and Samira have?

A One **B** Two
C Three **D** Four

4. How old is Karim's daughter?

A 5 **B** 8
C 15 **D** 18

4.5 Story

Before you read

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
habiter avec	ah-bee-TAY ah-VEK	to live with	J'habite avec ma famille. I live with my family.
le matin	luh mah-TA(N)	morning	Le matin, je parle français. In the morning, I speak French.
le soir	luh swahr	evening	Le soir, il étudie. In the evening, he studies.
le dimanche	luh dee-MAH(N)SH	on Sundays	Le dimanche, ma famille est à Ottawa. On Sundays, my family is in Ottawa.
la table	lah tahbl	table	La table est petite. The table is small.
manger	mah(n)-ZHAY	to eat	Manger avec ma famille. To eat with my family.

STORY

La famille de Karim

Karim's family

Karim habite à Montréal avec sa famille.
Karim lives in Montréal with his family.

Sa femme s'appelle Samira.
His wife is called Samira.

Ils ont deux enfants : un fils et une fille.
They have two children: a son and a daughter.
A colon (:) in French has a space before it: *deux enfants :*.

Leur fils, Omar, a huit ans. Il est grand.
Their son, Omar, is eight. He is tall.

Leur fille, Yasmine, a cinq ans. Elle est petite et très gentille.
Their daughter, Yasmine, is five. She is small and very kind.

Karim travaille à l'hôpital le matin.
Karim works at the hospital in the morning.

Samira étudie le français le soir.
Samira studies French in the evening.

Le dimanche, ils sont tous à la table de la grand-mère.
On Sundays, they are all at grandmother's table.
tous means *all*: here, everyone together.

Ils sont contents. C'est une belle famille.
They are happy. It is a beautiful family.

READING 4.5

Story questions

Choose the best answer.

1. How many children do Karim and Samira have?

A One
B Two
C Three
D Four

2. When does Samira study French?

A In the morning
B In the evening
C On Sundays only
D At noon

3. Where do they eat on Sunday?

A At the hospital
B At a restaurant
C At the grandmother's table
D At school

4.6 Listening

LISTENING 4.6

People and families

You hear each recording once.

1. What colour is Ali's hair?

A Black
B Brown
C Blond
D Red

2. Who works at the hospital?

A His father
B His mother
C His sister
D His uncle

3. How many daughters?

A One
B Two
C Three
D None

4. What is her husband's name?

A Marc
B Karim
C Sam
D Omar

5. How old are the grandparents?

A 60
B 70
C 80
D 90

4.7 Reading

Situation familiale : □ célibataire ☒ marié(e) □ conjoint(e) de fait □ divorcé(e)
Nom du conjoint : Haddad · Prénom : Samira · Nombre d'enfants : 2

READING 4.7a

A form

Read the form. Choose the best answer.

1. What is the marital status?

A Single
B Married
C Common-law
D Divorced

2. How many children?

A 0
B 1
C 2
D 3

Voici ma sœur. Elle s'appelle Léa. Elle a vingt ans. Elle est petite et blonde. Elle a les yeux bleus. Elle est étudiante.

READING 4.7b

A description

Read the text. Choose the best answer.

1. How old is Léa?

A 12
B 20
C 22
D 30

2. What does Léa look like?

A Tall with dark hair
B Small and blond with blue eyes
C Tall and blond
D Small with brown hair

3. What does Léa do?

A She works
B She studies
C She cooks
D She travels

4.8 Writing

WRITING 4.8W

Describe your family

Write 5 sentences about your family: who they are, their age and one thing about each (a job, hair, a colour). Use *mon, ma, mes*.

Check your text:

- *mon / ma / mes* match the noun.
- Adjectives agree: *elle est grande*.
- *Elle a vingt ans* (avoir, not être).

WRITING 4.8W2

Fill 'situation familiale'

Write one line that gives your marital status and, if you have them, the name of your spouse and your children.

Check your text:

- Choose the form for your gender: *marié* or *mariée*.

4.9 Speaking

SPEAKING 4.9S

Show a photo

Show a family photo (or imagine one). Say who is who, how old they are, and what they look like. Use *Voici…*, *Il / Elle est…*, *Il / Elle a… ans*. Record yourself.

- Keep the sentences short and say each one cleanly.
- Use *et* to join: *Il est grand et blond.*

4.10 TCF corner and checkpoint

LISTENING 4.10L

TCF listening (one play)

You hear each recording once.

1. Who is in the family?

A Father, mother and brother
B Father, mother and sister
C Mother and sister
D Brother and sister

2. How old is the boy?

A 8
B 10
C 12
D 15

3. What is the aunt like?

A Kind
B Tired
C Angry
D Young

4. What colour is her hair?

A Red
B Brown
C Blond
D Black

READING 4.10R

TCF reading

Read. Choose the best answer.

Ma sœur est grande. Elle a vingt-deux ans. Elle travaille à Toronto.

1. Where does the sister work?

A Ottawa
B Montréal
C Toronto
D Québec

Mon père est célibataire. Mon oncle est marié.

2. Who is single?

A The father
B The uncle
C The mother
D The brother

Nous avons deux filles. Elles s'appellent Léa et Nadia.

3. How many daughters?

A 1
B 2
C 3
D 4

READING 4.10C

Checkpoint: 10 questions

Aim for 8 or more before moving on.

1. ___ mère (my mother)

A mon
B ma
C mes
D son

2. ___ amie (my friend, f.)

A ma
B mon
C mes
D ta

3. Elle est ___. (tall)

A grand
B grande
C grands
D grandes

4. Ils ___ à Ottawa.

A habite
B habitent
C habitons
D habitez

5. Nous ___ français.

A parle
B parlez
C parlons
D parlent

6. 'Son père' means...

A my father
B his or her father
C your father
D their father

7. Which adjective goes BEFORE the noun?

A canadien
B grand
C rouge
D français

8. 'conjoint' on a form means...

A spouse or partner
B child
C neighbour
D friend

9. The feminine of 'beau' is...

A bele
B belle
C beaux
D beau

10. 'fils' is said...

A fee
B fees
C fiy
D fill

Unit 4 checklist

- I can name my family and say how old they are.
- I can use mon, ma, mes and son, sa, ses.
- I can make an adjective agree with a noun.
- I can describe hair, eyes and colours.

- I can conjugate -er verbs with all persons.
- I can say my marital status and read a *situation familiale* form.

UNIT 5

5

Numbers, money and prices

AFTER THIS UNIT YOU CAN

Understand and say prices in dollars and cents, ask how much something costs, understand taxes and a total, and pay by cash or card.

THE SITUATION

At a café, a corner store, a pharmacy, on a phone bill, with a landlord. Numbers decide what you pay, so numbers are also what the exam checks most in the first questions. This unit makes you confident with them.

In Canada Canada uses **dollars ($) and cents**. On prices, the **comma** separates cents and the **$ comes after** the number: **3,50 $**. In English it is the opposite: $3.50.

In Canada Sales tax is added at the register: **TPS** (GST, 5%) everywhere, plus **TVQ** (QST, 9.975%) in Québec, or **TVH** (HST) in some provinces. Prices on shelves are often **avant taxes** (before tax).

5.1 Words

Group 1: money words

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
l'argent (m.)	lahR-ZHAH(N)	money	Je n'ai pas d'argent. I have no money.
le dollar	luh doh-LAHR	dollar	Ça coûte cinq dollars. It costs five dollars.
le cent	luh sah(n)t	cent (Québec: la cenne, informal)	Dix cents. Ten cents.
le prix	luh pree	price	Quel est le prix ? What is the price?
coûter	koo-TAY	to cost	Combien ça coûte ? How much does it cost?
cher / chère	shehr	expensive	C'est cher. It is expensive.
bon marché	boh(n) mahr-SHAY	cheap, inexpensive	C'est bon marché. It is inexpensive.
gratuit / gratuite	grah-TWEE / grah-TWEET	free (no cost)	L'entrée est gratuite. Entry is free.
payer	peh-YAY	to pay	Je paie avec ma carte. I pay with my card.
acheter	ahsh-TAY	to buy	J'achète du pain. I am buying bread.

Group 2: ways to pay and bills

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
l'argent comptant	lahr-zhah(n) koh(n)-TAH(N)	cash	Vous payez comptant ? Are you paying cash?
la carte de débit	lah kahrt duh day-BEE	debit card	Je paie avec ma carte de débit. I pay with my debit card.
la carte de crédit	lah kahrt duh kray-DEE	credit card	Vous payez avec la carte de crédit ? Are you paying with a credit card?
Interac	a(n)-tehr-AHK	Canadian debit payment (tap or chip)	Je paie par Interac. I pay with Interac.
le reçu	luh ruh-SÜ	receipt	Voici votre reçu. Here is your receipt.
la monnaie	lah moh-NEH	change (coins), small change	Voici votre monnaie. Here is your change.
la facture	lah fahk-TÜR	bill, invoice	La facture d'électricité. The electricity bill.
le loyer	luh lwah-YAY	rent	Le loyer est de mille deux cents dollars. The rent is 1,200 dollars.
par mois / par semaine	pahr mwah / pahr suh-MEHN	per month / per week	Vingt dollars par semaine. Twenty dollars per week.
par heure	pahr uhr	per hour	Quinze dollars par heure. Fifteen dollars per hour.

Group 3: taxes and savings

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
la taxe	lah tahks	tax	La taxe est de cinq pour cent. The tax is five percent.

la TPS	lah tay-pay-ESS	GST (federal sales tax)	La TPS est de cinq pour cent. GST is five percent.
la TVQ	lah tay-vay-KÜ	QST (Québec sales tax)	La TVQ est au Québec. QST is in Québec.
avant taxes / plus taxes	ah-VAH(N) tahks / plü tahks	before tax / plus tax	Dix dollars avant taxes. Ten dollars before tax.
le total	luh toh-TAHL	total	Le total est de sept dollars. The total is seven dollars.
le sous-total	luh soo-toh-TAHL	subtotal	Le sous-total est de six dollars. The subtotal is six dollars.
le rabais	luh rah-BEH	discount	Vingt pour cent de rabais. Twenty percent off.
en solde	ah(n) sohld	on sale	C'est en solde. It is on sale.
pour cent	poor sah(n)	percent	Quinze pour cent. Fifteen percent.
demander	duh-mah(n)-DAY	to ask	Je demande le prix. I ask for the price.

Watch out **cent** (100) and **cent** (the coin) are written the same. Context tells them apart: *cent dollars* = 100 dollars. *Dix cents* = 10 cents. **sept** cents (700) and **cent** (a cent) are not the same: write the number clearly.

5.2 Phrases

At the register

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
Combien ça coûte ?	koh(n)-BYA(N) sah koot	How much does it cost?	
C'est combien ?	seh koh(n)-BYA(N)	How much is it?	
Ça fait combien ?	sah feh koh(n)-BYA(N)	What does it come to?	
Ça fait six dollars vingt-cinq.	sah feh see doh-LAHR va(n)-SA(N)k	That is 6.25 dollars.	
C'est trop cher.	seh troh shehr	It is too expensive.	
Vous payez comment ?	voo peh-yay koh-MAH(N)	How are you paying?	
Je paie par carte.	zhuh peh pahr kahrt	I pay by card.	
Comptant ou par carte ?	koh(n)-tah(n) oo pahr kahrt	Cash or card?	
Le reçu, s'il vous plaît.	luh ruh-SÜ seel voo PLEH	The receipt, please.	
Le total est de sept dollars dix-huit.	luh toh-TAHL eh duh set doh-LAHR dee-ZWEET	The total is $7.18.	

In Canada Say prices like this: **7,18 $ = sept dollars dix-huit** (you do not need to say *cents*). **0,75 $ = soixante-quinze cents**. **12 $ = douze dollars**. For **1 200 $** say **mille deux cents dollars**. In Québec you may hear **piastre** for dollar and **cenne** for cent in casual talk. That is informal: you understand it, but you write **dollar** and **cent**.

5.3 Grammar: numbers, prices and dollars (g14)

A. How to say and read a price

Prices in French

WRITTEN	YOU SAY
3,50 $	trois dollars cinquante
12,99 $	douze dollars quatre-vingt-dix-neuf
0,75 $	soixante-quinze cents

21 $	vingt et un dollars
80 $	quatre-vingts dollars
1 450 $	mille quatre cent cinquante dollars
15 %	quinze pour cent
7,18 $ (total)	sept dollars dix-huit

- **Dollar sign after the number, comma for cents, space for thousands:** *12,50 $* and *1 200 $*.
- **vingt** and **cent** take **s** when they are multiplied and nothing follows: *quatre-vingts dollars* (80), *deux cents dollars* (200). With another number after: *quatre-vingt-deux*, *deux cent trois*.
- **dollar** takes **s** after 2 and more: *trois dollars*; **cent** (coin) also: *dix cents*.

B. Asking the price: three ways, same meaning

QUESTION	ANSWER
Combien ça coûte ?	Ça coûte quatre dollars.
C'est combien ?	C'est quatre dollars.
Ça fait combien ?	Ça fait quatre dollars. (used for a total)

Tip Learn the **chunk** *Ça fait … dollars* for totals at the register, and *Ça coûte …* for a single price. Clerks mostly say *Ça fait*.

C. acheter and payer: the spelling change

Two common -er verbs change a letter in some forms. You hear and see the change in **je, tu, il/elle and ils/elles**. **nous** and **vous** are regular.

	ACHETER	PAYER
je	j'achète (zhah-SHET)	je paie / je paye (zhuh peh)
tu	tu achètes	tu paies
il / elle	il achète	elle paie
nous	nous achetons (ahsh-TOH(N))	nous payons (peh-YOH(N))
vous	vous achetez	vous payez (peh-YAY)
ils / elles	ils achètent	elles paient

D. Taxes and totals (reading a receipt)

A receipt

LINE	MEANING
Sous-total	before tax
TPS 5 %	federal tax
TVQ 9,975 %	Québec tax
Total	what you pay

EXERCISE 5.3A

Say it in French

Write each price in French words.

1. 3,50 $
2. 12,99 $
3. 0,75 $
4. 21 $
5. 80 $
6. 1 450 $

EXERCISE 5.3B

Write the number

Write each price with digits and $ (comma for cents).

1. quinze dollars cinquante
2. deux dollars vingt-cinq
3. quarante-cinq dollars
4. mille deux cents dollars
5. soixante-treize cents

EXERCISE 5.3C

Complete the verb

Write the right form of *acheter* or *payer*.

1. J'___ du pain. (acheter)
2. Nous ___ avec la carte. (payer)
3. Vous ___ comptant ? (payer)
4. Elle ___ un manteau. (acheter)
5. Ils ___ le loyer. (payer)

EXERCISE 5.3D

Add the tax

A bill is 10,00 $. With TPS (5 %) it is 10,50 $. Write the total in words.

1. 10,00 $ + TPS 5 %
2. 20,00 $ + TPS 5 %
3. 100,00 $ + TPS 5 %

5.4 Dialogues

Words you need for the dialogues

FRENCH	SAY IT	ENGLISH	IN A SENTENCE
je vous écoute	zhuh voo zay-KOOT	I am listening (what would you like?)	Bonjour, je vous écoute. Hello, what would you like?
regarder	Ruh-gahR-DAY	to look at	Elle regarde les prix. She looks at the prices.
voilà	vwah-LAH	there you are	Voilà votre café. Here is your coffee.
le café / le croissant	luh kah-FAY / luh krwah-SAH(N)	coffee / croissant	Le café est chaud. The coffee is hot.
le sandwich	luh sah(n)d-WEESH	sandwich	Un sandwich, s'il vous plaît. A sandwich, please.
le manteau / les manteaux	luh mah(n)-TOH / lay mah(n)-TOH	coat / coats	Le manteau est noir. The coat is black.
le propriétaire	luh proh-pree-ay-TEHR	landlord, owner	Le propriétaire est gentil. The landlord is kind.
le virement	luh vee-ruh-MAH(N)	bank transfer	Je paie par virement. I pay by transfer.
le premier	luh pruh-MYAY	the first (of the month)	Le loyer est le premier du mois. The rent is due on the first of the month.
l'électricité (f.)	lay-lek-tree-see-TAY	electricity	L'électricité coûte quatre-vingts dollars. Electricity costs eighty dollars.
bonne soirée	bun swah-RAY	have a good evening	Merci, bonne soirée ! Thank you, have a good evening!
à bientôt	ah byeh(n)-TOH	see you soon	Merci, à bientôt ! Thank you, see you soon!

At the café

Léa pays for a coffee. The clerk and Léa use vous.

Employé Bonjour. Je vous écoute.
Hello. I am listening (what would you like?).

Léa Un café et un croissant, s'il vous plaît.
A coffee and a croissant, please.

Employé Voilà. Ça fait six dollars.
Here you are. That is 6 dollars.

Léa C'est combien avec les taxes ?
How much is it with taxes?

Employé Avec les taxes, ça fait six dollars quatre-vingt-dix.
With taxes, it is 6.90.

Léa Je paie par carte.
I pay by card.

Employé D'accord. Le reçu ?
Okay. The receipt?

Léa Oui, s'il vous plaît. Merci !
Yes, please. Thank you!

Rent and a bill

Sam and his landlord. They use vous.

Sam Bonjour, monsieur. Le loyer est de combien ?
Hello, sir. How much is the rent?

Le propriétaire Le loyer est de mille deux cents dollars par mois.
The rent is 1,200 dollars per month.

Sam Et l'électricité ?
And the electricity?

Le propriétaire L'électricité coûte quatre-vingts dollars par mois.
Electricity costs 80 dollars per month.

Sam Je paie le loyer comment ?
How do I pay the rent?

Le propriétaire Par virement, le premier du mois.
By transfer, on the first of the month.

READING 5.4

Understand the dialogues

Choose the best answer.

1. How much is the order before taxes?

A $5.00 **B** $6.00
C $6.90 **D** $7.50

2. How much is the order with taxes?

A $6.00 **B** $6.50
C $6.90 **D** $7.90

3. How does Léa pay?

A Cash **B** By card
C By transfer **D** She does not pay

4. How much is the rent?

A $800 **B** $1 000
C $1 200 **D** $2 000

5. How does Sam pay the rent?

A By cash **B** By card
C By transfer **D** By cheque

5.5 Story

STORY

Combien ça coûte ?

How much does it cost?

Julie est au dépanneur.
Julie is at the convenience store.
In Québec, a dépanneur (or dép) is a corner store. In France you would say épicerie or supérette.

Elle regarde les prix.
She looks at the prices.

Le lait coûte trois dollars cinquante.
The milk costs $3.50.

Le pain coûte deux dollars soixante-quinze.
The bread costs $2.75.

« Ça fait combien ? » demande Julie.
"How much is that?" asks Julie.

« Ça fait six dollars vingt-cinq, plus les taxes. »
"That is $6.25, plus taxes."

Les taxes, c'est quatre-vingt-treize cents.
The taxes are 93 cents.
In Québec: TPS (5 %) + TVQ (9,975 %) is about 15 %. 6,25 $ gives roughly 0,93 $ of tax.

Le total est de sept dollars dix-huit.
The total is $7.18.

Julie paie avec sa carte de débit.
Julie pays with her debit card.

« Merci ! Bonne soirée ! »
"Thank you! Have a nice evening!"
Bonne soirée is the usual evening goodbye.

READING 5.5

Story questions

Choose the best answer.

1. What is the total?

A $6.25
B $7.18
C $8.18
D $6.93

2. How much is the milk?

A $2.75
B $3.50
C $3.75
D $6.25

3. How does Julie pay?

A Cash
B Debit card
C Credit card
D Transfer

5.6 Listening

LISTENING 5.6

Prices and payments

You hear each recording once.

1. How much is the coffee?

A $2.05
B $2.15
C $2.50
D $12.15

2. How much?

A $14
B $40
C $47
D $74

3. How does the customer pay?

A By card
B In cash
C By cheque
D By transfer

4. What is the rent?

A $1 050
B $1 150
C $1 500
D $11 500

5. What is the discount?

A 2 %
B 12 %
C 20 %
D 50 %

5.7 Reading

Lait ..... 3,50 $
Pain ..... 2,75 $
Sous-total ..... 6,25 $
TPS ..... 0,31 $
TVQ ..... 0,62 $
Total ..... 7,18 $
Paiement : carte de débit

READING 5.7a

A receipt

Read the receipt. Choose the best answer.

1. What is the subtotal?

A $3.50
B $6.25
C $7.18
D $0.93

2. What is the total?

A $6.25
B $7.18
C $7.81
D $8.18

3. How did the customer pay?

A Cash
B Debit card
C Credit card
D Transfer

Loyer : 1 200 $ par mois · Électricité : 80 $ par mois · Paiement le premier du mois, par virement.

READING 5.7b

Rent information

Read the text. Choose the best answer.

1. How much is the electricity per month?

A $8
B $80
C $800
D $1 200

2. When is the payment?

A The 1st of the month
B The 15th
C The last day
D Every week

5.8 Writing

WRITING 5.8W

Write the prices in words

Write each price in French words: 4,25 $ · 18 $ · 62,50 $ · 0,90 $.

Check your text:

- Dollar sign after the number in digits, but write words in a sentence.
- *quatre-vingt-dix* has hyphens.

WRITING 5.8W2

A short message

Write a short message to a friend: say what you bought, how much it cost, and how you paid.

Check your text:

- *J'achète, je paie.*
- Say the amount in words.
- End with *À bientôt.*

5.9 Speaking

SPEAKING 5.9S

At the register

Say a short conversation: ask the price, hear the total, ask for the receipt and say how you pay. Use *Ça fait combien ? Je paie par carte. Le reçu, s'il vous plaît.* Record yourself.

- Say the numbers slowly and clearly.
- If you do not catch the price, say *Pardon ? Plus lentement, s'il vous plaît.*

5.10 TCF corner and checkpoint

LISTENING 5.10L

TCF listening (one play)

You hear each recording once.

1. How much is the sandwich?

A $8.40 **B** $8.80
C $18.80 **D** $80.80

2. How much is the bill?

A $12 **B** $102
C $120 **D** $220

3. How does the person pay?

A Card **B** Cash
C Transfer **D** Cheque

4. What is the monthly rent?

A $590 **B** $905
C $950 **D** $1 950

READING 5.10R

TCF reading

Read. Choose the best answer.

Rabais de 30 % : tous les manteaux. Plus taxes.

1. What is the discount?

A 3 % **B** 13 %
C 30 % **D** 50 %

Total : 45,00 $ · TPS : 2,25 $ · À payer : 47,25 $

2. How much do you pay?

A $45 **B** $2.25
C $47.25 **D** $92.25

Le café est gratuit le dimanche.

3. What is free?

A Bread
B Coffee
C The bus
D The rent

READING 5.10C

Checkpoint: 10 questions

Aim for 8 or more before moving on.

1. How do you write 'twelve dollars fifty'?

A $12.50
B 12,50 $
C 12 50$
D $12,50

2. 'quatre-vingts' is...

A 40
B 60
C 80
D 90

3. 'Ça fait combien ?' asks...

A the time
B the total
C the name
D the age

4. 'TPS' is...

A a provincial tax
B the federal sales tax (GST)
C a bank
D a card

5. 'C'est trop cher' means...

A It is free
B It is too expensive
C It is cheap
D It is on sale

6. 'Je paie par carte' means...

A I pay by card
B I buy a card
C I have a card
D I lose a card

7. '20 % de rabais' means...

A 20 % tax
B 20 % off
C 20 % more
D 20 dollars

8. 'Par mois' means...

A per week
B per month
C per day
D per year

9. Nous ___ le loyer. (payer)

A paie
B payons
C payez
D paient

10. J'___ du pain. (acheter)

A achète
B achetons
C achetez
D achètent

Unit 5 checklist

- I can say and read prices with dollars and cents.
- I can ask how much something costs in three ways.
- I understand a receipt: sous-total, TPS, TVQ, total.
- I can pay and ask for a receipt.
- I can use acheter and payer.
- I understand rent, bills, discounts and percentages.

ANSWER KEY

Answers, audio scripts and model texts

Do the exercise first. Then check. Read the audio scripts only after you answered the listening questions.

Stage 0: Sounds and spelling

Reading 0.1: What does the sign say?

1. A Out. Sortie means exit.
2. B Stop. Arrêt means stop.
3. C The shop is closed. Fermé means closed.
4. B The way in. Entrée means entrance.

Exercise 0.2A: Say the letters

1. ess-ah-emm
2. ell-uh-ah (the accent is said: ell, é accent aigu, ah)
3. emm-ah-ehR-say
4. zhee-ü-ell-ee-uh
5. tay-ehR-uh-emm-bay-ell-ah-ee-GREK
6. kü-é accent aigu-bay-uh-say

Listening 0.2: Spelled names

Audio: Mon nom, c'est Diallo. D-I-A-deux L-O. **1. A** Diallo. D-I-A-L-L-O: two Ls, so Diallo.
Audio: Prénom : Awa. A-W-A. **2. B** Awa. A-W-A: the W is doo-bluh-vay.
Audio: Nom : Gagnon. G-A-G-N-O-N. **3. A** Gagnon. G-A-G-N-O-N is Gagnon, a very common Québec surname.
Audio: Mon courriel : sam, arobase, exemple, point c-a. **4. B** .ca. Point c-a is .ca, the Canadian ending.

Speaking 0.2S: Say your own name (model)

Je m'appelle Sam Tremblay. Ça s'écrit T-R-E-M-B-L-A-Y. Mon courriel est sam, arobase, exemple, point c-a.

Exercise 0.3A: Choose the right word

1. a
2. à
3. Où
4. ou

Exercise 0.4A: Read aloud, then sort

1. eh
2. oo
3. wah
4. ü
5. oh
6. ay

Listening 0.4: Which word did you hear?

Audio: trois **1. A** trois. Trois is trwah.
Audio: beau **2. B** beau. Beau is boh.
Audio: vous **3. C** vous. Vous is voo.
Audio: mère **4. B** mère. Mère is mehR (mother).

Listening 0.5: u or ou?

Audio: tout **1. B** tout. Tout is too (oo), not tü.
Audio: rue **2. B** rue. Rue is Rü (street).
Audio: sous **3. B** sous. Sous is soo (under).
Audio: deux **4. B** deux. Deux is duh (two).

Speaking 0.5S: Pairs out loud (model)

tu, tout. rue, roue. dessus, dessous.

Listening 0.6: Nasal vowels

Audio: bon **1. B** bon. Bon is boh(n).
Audio: vent **2. C** vent. Vent is vah(n) (wind).
Audio: pain **3. C** pain. Pain is pa(n) (bread).
Audio: quinze **4. B** quinze. Quinze is ka(n)z (fifteen).

Exercise 0.7A: Say it, then write the sound

1. shah
2. KAHtr
3. gahR
4. zhee-RAHF
5. moh(n)-TAHNY
6. tay

Listening 0.7: Listen carefully

Audio: poisson **1. B** poisson. Poisson is pwah-SOH(N) (fish).
Audio: chat **2. A** chat. Chat is shah (cat).
Audio: garçon **3. B** garçon. Garçon is gahR-SOH(N) (boy).
Audio: quatre **4. B** quatre. Quatre is KAHtr (four).

Speaking 0.8S: R practice (model)

rue, rouge, merci, par, bonjour, regarder.

Listening 0.9: Joined words

Audio: les amis **1. A** les amis. Les amis is lay-zah-MEE, with the z link.
Audio: vous êtes **2. A** vous êtes. Vous êtes is voo-ZET.
Audio: j'habite à Montréal **3. B** Montréal. J'habite à Montréal: I live in Montréal.

Audio: c'est un homme **4. B** a man. Un homme is a man. C'est un homme: it is a man.

Exercise 0.10A: Numbers to French

1. trois
2. sept
3. douze
4. quinze
5. dix-huit
6. vingt

Listening 0.10: Numbers

Audio: Le train part du quai numéro huit. **1. B** Platform 8. Huit is 8.
Audio: Ça fait quatorze dollars. **2. B** $14. Quatorze is 14.
Audio: L'autobus seize arrive. **3. B** Bus 16. Seize is 16.
Audio: Mon numéro est le cinq, un, quatre, deux, zéro, neuf, un. **4. B** 5-1-4. Cinq, un, quatre is 5-1-4.

Exercise 0.11A: Numbers to French

1. vingt et un
2. quarante-cinq
3. soixante-douze
4. quatre-vingts
5. quatre-vingt-quinze
6. mille deux cents dollars

Listening 0.11: Prices and numbers

Audio: Le loyer est de mille deux cents dollars par mois. **1. B** $1 200. Mille deux cents is 1 200.
Audio: Ça fait soixante-douze dollars. **2. B** $72. Soixante-douze is 72 (60 + 12).
Audio: Le numéro est le quatre-vingt-quinze. **3. B** 95. Quatre-vingt-quinze is 4 × 20 + 15 = 95.
Audio: Nous sommes en deux mille vingt-six. **4. C** 2026. Deux mille vingt-six is 2026.

Exercise 0.12A: Falling or rising?

1. ↘
2. ↗
3. ↘
4. ↘
5. ↗

Listening 0.12: Statement or question?

Audio: Vous êtes canadien ? **1. B** a yes/no question. Voice goes up: it is a yes/no question.
Audio: Il est huit heures. **2. B** a statement. Voice goes down: it is a statement.
Audio: Où est la gare ? **3. A** Where the station is. Où est la gare ? means Where is the station?

Speaking 0.12S: Melody practice (model)

Il parle français. (↘) Il parle français ? (↗)

Listening 0.13: A first Canadian listening

Audio: Bonjour, ici la clinique Sainte-Anne. Votre rendez-vous est lundi à neuf heures trente. Merci et bonne journée. **1. A** Monday at 9:30. Lundi (Monday), neuf heures trente (9:30).
Audio: Votre attention, s'il vous plaît. Le train pour Lyon part à quatorze heures dix, quai numéro trois. **2. B** Platform 3. Quai numéro trois: platform 3.
Audio: Bonsoir ! Le dépanneur est ouvert jusqu'à vingt-trois heures. **3. A** At 11 pm. Vingt-trois heures is 23:00, 11 pm. Dépanneur is a Québec corner store.
Audio: Salut ! C'est Marc. Mon numéro est le cinq, un, quatre, cinq, cinq, cinq, zéro, un, deux, trois. **4. B** 514. Cinq, un, quatre is 514, the Montréal area code.

Speaking 0.13S: Your first Canadian phone message (model)

Bonjour, je m'appelle Sam Tremblay. Ça s'écrit T-R-E-M-B-L-A-Y. Mon numéro est le cinq, un, quatre, cinq, cinq, cinq, zéro, un, deux, trois. Merci.

Unit 1: Introduce yourself

Speaking 1.2S: Say it as a block (model)

Je m'appelle … Je suis … J'habite à … Je parle … Enchanté.

Exercise 1.3A: Complete with être

1. suis
2. es
3. est
4. sommes
5. êtes
6. sont

Exercise 1.3B: tu or vous?

1. tu
2. vous
3. vous
4. tu
5. vous
6. tu

Exercise 1.3C: Complete the verb

1. parle
2. habites
3. s'appelle
4. habite
5. parle
6. t'appelles

Exercise 1.3D: Masculine or feminine?

1. canadien
2. française
3. marocain
4. algérienne
5. indienne

6. chinois

Reading 1.4: Understand the dialogue

1. B Gatineau. J'habite à Gatineau.
2. B Her last name. Votre nom: her last name.
3. B She is Haitian. Je suis haïtienne.

Reading 1.5: Story questions

1. A Seven in the evening. Il est sept heures du soir.
2. B Nadia. Nadia est nouvelle.
3. C French and English. Elle parle français et anglais.

Listening 1.6: Short messages

Audio: Bonjour, je m'appelle Karim. Je suis marocain. J'habite à Montréal. **1. B** Montréal. J'habite à Montréal.
Audio: Vous parlez français, madame ? — Oui, un peu. Je parle anglais et espagnol. **2. B** English and Spanish. Anglais et espagnol; français un peu.
Audio: Salut ! Moi, c'est Priya. Je suis indienne. Je parle hindi et anglais. **3. B** Indian. Indienne is the feminine of indien.
Audio: Votre nom, s'il vous plaît ? — Gagnon. G-A-G-N-O-N. — Merci, monsieur. **4. A** Gagnon. G-A-G-N-O-N.
Audio: Allô ? Bonsoir, c'est Marc. Vous êtes madame Diallo ? **5. B** Evening. Bonsoir is the evening greeting.

Reading 1.7a: A form

1. B Haddad. Nom is the last name.
2. A Arabic and French. Langues: arabe, français.

Reading 1.7b: A short message

1. B She speaks a little. Un peu anglais: a little.
2. B Gatineau. J'habite à Gatineau.

Writing 1.8W: Introduce yourself in four sentences (model)

Je m'appelle Sam Tremblay. Je suis canadien. J'habite à Toronto. Je parle anglais et un peu français.

Writing 1.8W2: Fill a form (model)

Nom : Tremblay · Prénom : Sam · Nationalité : canadienne · Ville : Toronto · Langues : anglais, français.

Speaking 1.9S: Meet someone (model)

Bonjour, madame. Je m'appelle Sam. Comment vous appelez-vous ? … Enchanté. J'habite à Toronto. Je parle anglais et un peu français. Et vous ? … Moi aussi.

Listening 1.10L: TCF listening (one play)

Audio: Bonjour. Je m'appelle Léa. Mon nom, c'est Gagnon. **1. B** Gagnon. Mon nom, c'est Gagnon.
Audio: Je parle anglais. **2. B** English. Anglais is English.
Audio: J'habite à Montréal. **3. B** Montréal. J'habite à Montréal.
Audio: Salut ! Je suis Nadia. Je suis algérienne. **4. B** Algerian. Algérienne: from Algeria.

Reading 1.10R: TCF reading

1. B Ottawa. J'habite à Ottawa.
2. B Awa. Prénom is the first name.
3. B Three. Français, anglais, espagnol: three.

Reading 1.10C: Checkpoint: 10 questions

1. B nom. Nom is the last name.
2. A suis. Je suis.
3. B es. Tu es.
4. B vous. Vous is polite.
5. B s'appelle. Elle s'appelle.
6. B française. Feminine: française.
7. B I speak a little English. Un peu is a little.
8. B bonsoir. Bonsoir.
9. A habite. J'habite.
10. A canadienne. Canadienne.

Unit 2: Greet, be polite, spell your name

Speaking 2.2S: Rescue phrases (model)

Pardon ? Pouvez-vous répéter, s'il vous plaît ? Plus lentement, s'il vous plaît. Merci beaucoup.

Exercise 2.3A: avoir

1. ai
2. as
3. a
4. avons
5. avez
6. ont

Exercise 2.3B: Make it a question

1. Est-ce que vous parlez français ?
2. Est-ce que tu habites à Ottawa ?

3. Est-ce qu'elle comprend ?
4. Est-ce que vous avez un courriel ?

Exercise 2.3C: Which question word?

1. Quel
2. Comment
3. Où
4. Pourquoi

Exercise 2.3D: Age

1. J'ai vingt-cinq ans.
2. J'ai trente-deux ans.
3. J'ai quarante et un ans.
4. J'ai soixante ans.

Reading 2.4: Understand the dialogues

1. B He did not catch the email. Pardon ? Tu peux répéter ?
2. B Thirty-two. Trente-deux ans.
3. B Her cell number. Votre numéro de cellulaire.
4. A Bienvenue. Bienvenue: you're welcome (Canada).

Reading 2.5: Story questions

1. B At the library. Sam est à la bibliothèque.
2. A She did not hear the email. She asks him to repeat.
3. B Slowly. Sam répète lentement.

Listening 2.6: Short messages

Audio: Pardon, madame. Pouvez-vous répéter, s'il vous plaît ? **1. B** To hear it again. Répéter: say again.
Audio: Quel âge avez-vous ? — J'ai trente-deux ans. **2. B** 32. Trente-deux: 32.
Audio: Votre nom, s'il vous plaît ? — Diallo. D-I-A-L-L-O. **3. A** Diallo. D-I-A-L-L-O.
Audio: Merci beaucoup, monsieur. — Bienvenue, madame. **4. B** You're welcome. Bienvenue: you're welcome.
Audio: Quel est votre numéro de téléphone ? — C'est le cinq, un, quatre, cinq, cinq, cinq, zéro, un, neuf, huit. **5. A** 98. Neuf, huit: 98.

Reading 2.7a: A library card form

1. B 32. Âge : 32 ans.
2. C 613. 613 is the Ottawa area code.
3. B sam@exemple.ca. Courriel : sam@exemple.ca.

Reading 2.7b: A short message

1. B He does not understand. Je ne comprends pas.
2. B Repeat. Pouvez-vous répéter ?

Writing 2.8W: Ask someone to repeat (model)

Bonjour Marc. Pardon, je ne comprends pas. Pouvez-vous répéter plus lentement, s'il vous plaît ? Merci beaucoup !

Writing 2.8W2: Fill a library form (model)

Nom : Tremblay · Prénom : Sam · Âge : 32 ans · Courriel : sam@exemple.ca · Téléphone : 613 555 0142.

Speaking 2.9S: At the desk (model)

Bonjour. Je m'appelle Sam Tremblay. Ça s'écrit T-R-E-M-B-L-A-Y. J'ai trente-deux ans. Mon courriel est sam, arobase, exemple, point c-a. Mon numéro est le six, un, trois…

Listening 2.10L: TCF listening (one play)

Audio: Bonjour, ici Marc. Mon numéro de téléphone est le quatre, un, six, cinq, cinq, cinq, zéro, un, deux, trois. **1. A** Toronto. 416 is the Toronto area code.
Audio: Quel âge as-tu ? — J'ai vingt et un ans. **2. B** 21. Vingt et un: 21.
Audio: Pardon ? Plus lentement, s'il vous plaît. **3. A** To speak more slowly. Plus lentement: more slowly.
Audio: Mon courriel : L-E-A, arobase, exemple, point c-a. **4. B** .ca. Point c-a: .ca.

Reading 2.10R: TCF reading

1. B 28. Vingt-huit: 28.
2. B You're welcome. Bienvenue: you're welcome.
3. B A cell phone number. Numéro de cellulaire.

Reading 2.10C: Checkpoint: 10 questions

1. B Pouvez-vous répéter, s'il vous plaît ?. Polite and complete.
2. B ai. J'ai.
3. C a. Elle a.
4. A où. Où.
5. C comment. Comment.
6. B Parlez-vous français ?. Inversion is formal.
7. B I do not understand. Ne … pas: not.
8. B courriel. Courriel.
9. A Bienvenue. Bienvenue.
10. B the spelling. Spelling.

Unit 3: Forms and papers

Exercise 3.3A: le, la, l' or les?

1. le
2. l'
3. la
4. les
5. l'
6. la

Exercise 3.3B: un, une or des?

1. un
2. une
3. des
4. une
5. un
6. des

Exercise 3.3C: Make it plural

1. les formulaires
2. les rues
3. les adresses
4. les pays
5. les bureaux

Exercise 3.3D: Say the postal code

1. ahsh, trois, bay, un, ah, sept
2. kah, un, ah, zéro, bay, un
3. emm, cinq, vay, deux, tay, six

Reading 3.4: Understand the dialogue

1. A Passport and work permit. Mon passeport et mon permis de travail.
2. A April 15, 1990. Le quinze avril mille neuf cent quatre-vingt-dix.
3. B 4. Appartement quatre.
4. A To sign. Signez ici.

Reading 3.5: Story questions

1. B A form. L'agent donne un formulaire.
2. B The name. D'abord, le nom.
3. B Signs the form. Puis elle signe.

Listening 3.6: At the counter

Audio: Mon code postal est H, trois, B, un, A, sept. **1. A** H3B 1A7. H3B 1A7.
Audio: Je suis née le quinze avril mille neuf cent quatre-vingt-dix. **2. B** April. Avril: April.
Audio: J'habite au vingt-trois, rue Principale, appartement six. **3. B** 6. Appartement six.
Audio: Votre pièce d'identité, s'il vous plaît. — Voici mon passeport. **4. A** A passport. Passeport.
Audio: Signez ici, s'il vous plaît. **5. B** Sign. Signer: to sign.

Reading 3.7a: A form

1. B Québec. Province : Québec.
2. B Priya. Prénom : Priya.
3. B 1990. 1990-04-15.

Reading 3.7b: A sign

1. B A passport. Passeport is on the list.
2. C Photocopies. Les photocopies ne sont pas acceptées.

Writing 3.8W: Fill in the form (model)

Nom : Tremblay · Prénom : Sam · Date de naissance : 1992-03-08 · Adresse : 25, rue Principale, app. 3 · Ville : Ottawa · Province : Ontario · Code postal : K1A 0B1.

Writing 3.8W2: Write your address in a sentence (model)

J'habite au vingt-cinq, rue Principale, appartement trois. Mon code postal est K1A 0B1.

Speaking 3.9S: At the counter (model)

Bonjour, madame. Voici mon passeport. Je m'appelle Sam Tremblay. Je suis né le huit mars mille neuf cent quatre-vingt-douze. J'habite au vingt-cinq, rue Principale, appartement trois, Ottawa. Mon code postal est K, un, A, zéro, B, un.

Listening 3.10L: TCF listening (one play)

Audio: Bonjour. Voici mon adresse : quarante-deux, rue des Érables, Gatineau. **1. C** 42. Quarante-deux: 42.
Audio: Mon courriel est sam, arobase, exemple, point c-a. Mon numéro est le six, un, trois, cinq, cinq, cinq, zéro, un, quatre, deux. **2. C** Ottawa. 613 is the Ottawa area code.
Audio: Votre date de naissance, s'il vous plaît ? — Le trois mai deux mille. **3. A** May 3, 2000. Le trois mai deux mille.
Audio: Signez ici, s'il vous plaît. Et voici votre carte. **4. A** A card. Votre carte.

Reading 3.10R: TCF reading

1. A Passport and a permit. Passeport et permis.
2. C New Brunswick. Nouveau-Brunswick.
3. B September. 09 is September.

Reading 3.10C: Checkpoint: 10 questions

1. C l'. L'adresse.

2. A un. Un formulaire.
3. A les rues. Les rues.
4. A les pays. Pays does not change.
5. A born on. Né: born.
6. B The number. Number first.
7. B Ontario. Ontario.
8. A SIN. Social Insurance Number.
9. A votre. Votre.
10. A Sign here. Signer.

Unit 4: Family and people

Exercise 4.3A: mon, ma or mes?

1. mon
2. ma
3. mes
4. mon
5. ma
6. mes

Exercise 4.3B: Make it agree

1. grande
2. content
3. petite
4. jeunes
5. belle
6. mariés

Exercise 4.3C: Conjugate

1. parlons
2. habitez
3. travaillent
4. étudient
5. travaillons

Exercise 4.3D: son, sa or ses?

1. son
2. sa
3. ses
4. son

Reading 4.4: Understand the dialogues

1. C 60. Mon père a soixante ans.
2. B Green. Les yeux verts.
3. B Two. Deux enfants.
4. A 5. Ma fille a cinq ans.

Reading 4.5: Story questions

1. B Two. Deux enfants.
2. B In the evening. Le soir.
3. C At the grandmother's table. À la table de la grand-mère.

Listening 4.6: People and families

Audio: Voici mon frère. Il s'appelle Ali. Il est grand et il a les cheveux noirs. **1. A** Black. Les cheveux noirs.
Audio: Ma mère travaille à l'hôpital. Mon père travaille à la maison. **2. B** His mother. Ma mère.
Audio: Nous avons trois enfants : deux filles et un fils. **3. B** Two. Deux filles.
Audio: Elle est mariée. Son mari s'appelle Marc. **4. A** Marc. Son mari: Marc.
Audio: Mes grands-parents habitent à Gatineau. Ils ont quatre-vingts ans. **5. C** 80. Quatre-vingts: 80.

Reading 4.7a: A form

1. B Married. Marié(e) is ticked.
2. C 2. Nombre d'enfants : 2.

Reading 4.7b: A description

1. B 20. Vingt ans.
2. B Small and blond with blue eyes. Petite et blonde, les yeux bleus.
3. B She studies. Étudiante.

Writing 4.8W: Describe your family (model)

J'ai une petite famille. Mon père s'appelle Ali. Il a soixante ans et il travaille à l'hôpital. Ma mère s'appelle Nadia. Elle est gentille et elle a les yeux verts. J'ai une sœur : elle a vingt ans et elle étudie.

Writing 4.8W2: Fill 'situation familiale' (model)

Situation familiale : marié(e). Nom du conjoint : Haddad Samira. Enfants : Omar (8 ans), Yasmine (5 ans).

Speaking 4.9S: Show a photo (model)

Voici ma famille. Voici mon père : il a soixante ans, il est grand. Voici ma mère : elle est petite, elle a les cheveux bruns. Voici ma sœur Léa : elle est étudiante, elle a vingt ans.

Listening 4.10L: TCF listening (one play)

Audio: Bonjour, je m'appelle Léa. Voici ma famille : mon père, ma mère et mon frère. **1. A** Father, mother and brother. Père, mère, frère.

Audio: Mon fils a dix ans. Il est grand pour son âge. **2. B** 10. Dix ans.
Audio: Ma tante est professeure. Elle est très gentille. **3. A** Kind. Gentille: kind.
Audio: Elle a les cheveux roux et les yeux verts. **4. A** Red. Roux: red-haired.

Reading 4.10R: TCF reading

1. C Toronto. Elle travaille à Toronto.
2. A The father. Père: célibataire.
3. B 2. Deux filles.

Reading 4.10C: Checkpoint: 10 questions

1. B ma. Ma mère.
2. B mon. Mon amie.
3. B grande. Grande.
4. B habitent. Habitent.
5. C parlons. Parlons.
6. B his or her father. Son: his or her.
7. B grand. Grand: BAGS adjective.
8. A spouse or partner. Conjoint.
9. B belle. Belle.
10. B fees. Fees, with the s.

Unit 5: Numbers, money and prices

Exercise 5.3A: Say it in French

1. trois dollars cinquante
2. douze dollars quatre-vingt-dix-neuf
3. soixante-quinze cents
4. vingt et un dollars
5. quatre-vingts dollars
6. mille quatre cent cinquante dollars

Exercise 5.3B: Write the number

1. 15,50 $
2. 2,25 $
3. 45 $
4. 1 200 $
5. 0,73 $

Exercise 5.3C: Complete the verb

1. achète
2. payons
3. payez
4. achète
5. paient

Exercise 5.3D: Add the tax

1. dix dollars cinquante
2. vingt et un dollars
3. cent cinq dollars

Reading 5.4: Understand the dialogues

1. B $6.00. Ça fait six dollars (avant les taxes).
2. C $6.90. Six dollars quatre-vingt-dix: 6,90.
3. B By card. Par carte.
4. C $1 200. Mille deux cents.
5. C By transfer. Par virement.

Reading 5.5: Story questions

1. B $7.18. Sept dollars dix-huit.
2. B $3.50. Trois dollars cinquante.
3. B Debit card. Carte de débit.

Listening 5.6: Prices and payments

Audio: Le café coûte deux dollars quinze. **1. B** $2.15. Deux dollars quinze.
Audio: Ça fait quarante-sept dollars. **2. C** $47. Quarante-sept: 47.
Audio: Vous payez comment ? — Par carte, s'il vous plaît. **3. A** By card. Par carte.
Audio: Le loyer est de mille cent cinquante dollars par mois. **4. B** $1 150. Mille cent cinquante.
Audio: C'est en solde : vingt pour cent de rabais. **5. C** 20 %. Vingt pour cent.

Reading 5.7a: A receipt

1. B $6.25. Sous-total.
2. B $7.18. Total.
3. B Debit card. Carte de débit.

Reading 5.7b: Rent information

1. B $80. 80 $ par mois.
2. A The 1st of the month. Le premier du mois.

Writing 5.8W: Write the prices in words (model)

quatre dollars vingt-cinq · dix-huit dollars · soixante-deux dollars cinquante · quatre-vingt-dix cents

Writing 5.8W2: A short message (model)

Salut ! J'achète du pain et du lait au dépanneur. Ça fait sept dollars dix-huit. Je paie par carte. À bientôt !

Speaking 5.9S: At the register (model)

Bonjour. Ça fait combien, s'il vous plaît ? … Sept dollars dix-huit ? D'accord. Je paie par carte. Le reçu, s'il vous plaît. Merci, bonne soirée !

Listening 5.10L: TCF listening (one play)

Audio: Bonjour. Le sandwich coûte huit dollars quatre-vingts. **1. B** $8.80. Huit dollars quatre-vingts: 8,80.

Audio: Madame, votre facture est de cent vingt dollars. **2. C** $120. Cent vingt: 120.

Audio: Je paie comptant. Voici cinquante dollars. **3. B** Cash. Comptant: cash.

Audio: Le loyer est de neuf cent cinquante dollars par mois. **4. C** $950. Neuf cent cinquante: 950.

Reading 5.10R: TCF reading

1. C 30 %. 30 %.

2. C $47.25. À payer.

3. B Coffee. Le café est gratuit.

Reading 5.10C: Checkpoint: 10 questions

1. B 12,50 $. 12,50 $.

2. C 80. Quatre-vingts: 80.

3. B the total. Ça fait: it comes to.

4. B the federal sales tax (GST). Taxe sur les produits et services.

5. B It is too expensive. Trop cher.

6. A I pay by card. Payer par carte.

7. B 20 % off. Rabais: discount.

8. B per month. Mois: month.

9. B payons. Nous payons.

10. A achète. J'achète.

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l'âge (m.) age (Unit 2)
l'agent (m.) agent, officer (Unit 3)
l'aide (f.) help (Unit 2)
aider to help (Unit 2)
l'Alberta (f.) Alberta (Unit 3)
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le mandarin Mandarin (Unit 1)
manger to eat (Unit 4)
le Manitoba Manitoba (Unit 3)
le manteau / les manteaux coat / coats (Unit 5)
le mari husband (Unit 4)
marié / mariée married (Unit 4)
le Maroc Morocco (Unit 1)
marron brown (never changes) (Unit 4)
le matin morning (Unit 4)
mer sea (Stage 0)
merci thank you (Stage 0)
merci beaucoup thank you very much (Unit 2)
la mère mother (Unit 4)
mes parents my parents (Unit 4)
le message message (Unit 2)
moi / toi me / you (stressed forms) (Unit 1)
Moi aussi. Me too. (Unit 1)
mon amie my friend (f.) (Unit 4)
Mon code postal est H3B 1A7. My postal code is H3B 1A7. (Unit 3)
Mon courriel est... My email is... (Unit 2)
Mon fils a cinq ans. My son is five. (Unit 4)
mon père my father (Unit 4)
la monnaie change (coins), small change (Unit 5)
monsieur sir, Mr., man (Unit 1)
Montréal Montréal (Stage 0)
le mot word (Unit 2)
le NAS SIN (Social Insurance Number) (Unit 3)
la nationalité nationality (Unit 1)
né / née born (m. / f.) (Unit 3)
noir / noire black (Unit 4)
le nom last name, name (Unit 1)
le nom de famille family name (Unit 1)
le nombre number, quantity (Unit 4)
non no (Unit 1)
notre famille our family (Unit 4)
nous we (Unit 1)
Nous habitons à Ottawa. We live in Ottawa. (Unit 4)
nouveau / nouvelle new (Unit 1)
le Nouveau-Brunswick New Brunswick (Unit 3)
la Nouvelle-Écosse Nova Scotia (Unit 3)
le numéro number (Unit 2)
on we, one (informal) (Unit 1)
l'oncle / la tante uncle / aunt (Unit 4)
l'Ontario (m.) Ontario (Unit 3)
orange orange (never changes) (Unit 4)
où where (Stage 0)
ou or (Stage 0)
oui yes (Unit 1)
ouvert open (Stage 0)
pain bread (Stage 0)
par by, through (Stage 0)
par heure per hour (Unit 5)
par mois / par semaine per month / per week (Unit 5)
parce que because (Unit 2)
pardon pardon, sorry, excuse me (Unit 2)
Pardon ? Sorry? (I did not hear) (Unit 2)
les parents parents (also: relatives) (Unit 4)
parfait perfect (Unit 3)
parler to speak (Unit 1)
Pas de problème. No problem. (Unit 2)
le passeport passport (Unit 3)
payer to pay (Unit 5)
le pays country (Unit 1)
le père father (Unit 4)
le permis d'études study permit (Unit 3)
le permis de conduire driver's licence (Unit 3)
le permis de travail work permit (Unit 3)
la personne person (Unit 1)
petit / petite small, short (Unit 4)
un peu a little (Unit 1)
pharmacie pharmacy (Stage 0)
les Philippines (f.) the Philippines (Unit 1)
la photocopie photocopy (Unit 3)
la phrase sentence (Unit 2)
la pièce d'identité piece of ID (Unit 3)
plus more (Unit 2)
Plus lentement, s'il vous plaît. More slowly, please. (Unit 2)
point dot (.) (Stage 0)
le point dot, full stop (Unit 2)
pour cent percent (Unit 5)
pourquoi why (Unit 2)
Pouvez-vous répéter ? Can you repeat? (Stage 0)
Pouvez-vous répéter, s'il vous plaît ? Can you repeat, please? (Unit 2)
le premier the first (of the month) (Unit 5)
le prénom first name (Unit 1)
principal / principale main (Unit 3)
le prix price (Unit 5)
le professeur / la professeure teacher (Canada: la professeure) (Unit 4)
le propriétaire landlord, owner (Unit 5)
la province province (Unit 3)
puis then (Unit 3)
quand when (Unit 2)
que / quoi what (Unit 2)
Québec Québec (Stage 0)

le Québec Québec (Unit 1)
quel / quelle which, what (Unit 2)
Quel âge avez-vous ? How old are you? (formal) (Unit 2)
Quel est votre numéro de téléphone ? What is your phone number? (Unit 2)
la question question (Unit 2)
qui who (Unit 2)
quinze fifteen (Stage 0)
le rabais discount (Unit 5)
le reçu receipt (Unit 5)
Le reçu, s'il vous plaît. The receipt, please. (Unit 5)
regarder to look at (Stage 0)
remplir to fill in (Unit 3)
Remplissez ce formulaire. Fill in this form. (Unit 3)
répète repeats (répéter) (Unit 2)
répéter to repeat (Unit 2)
la réponse answer (Unit 2)
restaurant restaurant (Stage 0)
rose pink (Unit 4)
rouge red (Stage 0)
roux / rousse red-haired (Unit 4)
rue street (Stage 0)
la rue street (Unit 3)
sa sœur his / her sister (Unit 4)
salut hi (friends and family) (Unit 1)
le sandwich sandwich (Unit 5)
sept heures seven o'clock (Unit 1)
la signature signature (Unit 3)
signer to sign (Unit 3)
Signez ici. Sign here. (Unit 3)
la situation familiale marital status (form) (Unit 4)
le soir evening (Unit 1)
son frère his / her brother (Unit 4)
sortie exit (Stage 0)
le sous-total subtotal (Unit 5)
sympathique friendly, nice (informal: sympa) (Unit 4)
sœur sister (Stage 0)
la sœur sister (Unit 4)
la table table (Unit 4)
la taxe tax (Unit 5)
le téléphone telephone (Unit 2)
le total total (Unit 5)
Le total est de sept dollars dix-huit. The total is $7.18. (Unit 5)
tous / toutes all, everyone (Unit 4)
la TPS GST (federal sales tax) (Unit 5)
un trait d'union a hyphen (-) (Stage 0)
travailler to work (Unit 4)
très very (Stage 0)
Très bien. / Pas mal. Very well. / Not bad. (Unit 2)
troisième third (Unit 1)
tu you (one friend, family, child) (Unit 1)
la TVQ QST (Québec sales tax) (Unit 5)
un, une, des a, an, some (Unit 3)
la valise suitcase (Unit 1)
vert / verte green (Unit 4)
veuf / veuve widowed (Unit 4)
vieux / vieille old (not for people politely: say âgé) (Unit 4)
la ville city, town (Unit 1)
le virement bank transfer (Unit 5)
voici / voilà here is / there is (Unit 3)
Voici ma famille. Here is my family. (Unit 4)
Voici mon passeport. Here is my passport. (Unit 3)
voilà there you are (Unit 5)
Votre pièce d'identité, s'il vous plaît. Your ID, please. (Unit 3)
vous you (formal, or more than one) (Unit 1)
Vous parlez français ? Do you speak French? (formal) (Unit 1)
Vous payez comment ? How are you paying? (Unit 5)
les yeux (m.) eyes (Unit 4)